

The Noble Abridged Ritual Tantra of the Wrathful Vajra King

Ārya-vajra-krodha-rāja-kalpa-laghu-tantra-nāma · Toh 632 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྩོམ་བྱའི་རྩུ་པའི་རྩོ་པ་བསྟན་པའི་རྩུ་

Toh 632 in the Kangyur is a tantric scripture known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-vajra-krodha-rāja-kalpa-laghu-tantra and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Dorje Khrowö Gyalpö Tokpa Düpe Gyud, rendered in English as "The Noble Abridged Ritual Tantra of the Wrathful Vajra King." It belongs to the class of Buddhist tantric texts and concerns the wrathful vajra deity known as the Wrathful Vajra King, presenting an abridged or condensed ritual tantra associated with this powerful figure. The text opens in the traditional sūtra style, with the Buddha residing in a magnificent celestial palace in the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations, situated upon a vajra essence maṇḍala, suggesting a revelatory setting appropriate to tantric scripture. As part of the Kangyur, it is counted among the translated word of the Buddha and is placed within the broader collection of tantric texts preserved in the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: Ārya-vajra-krodha-rāja-kalpa-laghu-tantra-nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Abridged Ritual Tantra of the Wrathful Vajra King.

Homage to the glorious Mañjuśrī.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One dwelled upon the vajra essence maṇḍala of the wind circle of the sky in the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations (Paranirmitavaśavartin), consecrated by blessing, at the center of a palace of stacked stories, exceedingly tall, extending for a hundred thousand leagues, adorned with divine, immeasurable mansions numbering eight hundred million, themselves constructed from the seven precious substances — with thrones of many jewels, lotus-seats and lion-supports; with reliquary shrines of multi-faceted precious stone at the crowning pinnacles, adorned with lotuses, wheels, and parasols raised on high, from which silken pennants streamed and billowed; with shadows cast upon the ground below, whereupon the assemblies of bodhisattvas descended from their divine vehicles and entered within. Beautiful with manifold ornaments: varied bells, victory banners, garlands of jeweled flowers, nets, half-nets, fly whisks, half-moons, half-vajras, hanging festoons and tassels, and much else besides; pervaded by porticos, vestibules, door panels, jeweled mirrors, parasols, and yet more;

beautified by many layered tiers of precious stones — amid all of this, the Blessed One dwelled together with the great maṇḍala of his retinue.

That assembly was as follows. The gathering of bodhisattvas included noble Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Samantabhadra, Maitreya, Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, Śāntamati, Vicitravikīrṇa, Gaganalocanadhara, Ākāśagarbha, Rūpaśuddha, Kṣitigarbha, Vajrapāṇi, and others — seventy million great bodhisattvas (mahāsattvas) in all. Śāriputra, Maudgalyāyana, Aśvajit, Kāśyapa, and others — forty million śrāvakas. The great and famed Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara, Kubera, Yama, Nandīśvara, and others — three hundred classes of deities. Together with this multifaceted retinue of bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, and world-protectors, the Blessed One generated a great, majestic display in harmony with the diverse intentions and aspirations of those present, performing many miraculous displays and emanating many rays of light, and thus remained in their midst.

Then the Blessed One, gazing upon the retinue with a gentle smile, extended the faculty of his tongue, and spoke to the great bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi:

Through the gateway of letters, names, words, and speech,
blessed by the Dharma of mantra-form —
whether a mere syllable, a half or a whole,
direct perception and inference, long and short,
indicated by the marks of vowels and consonants —
I, who embody the ten grounds, the ten perfections,
the ten masteries, the ten aims, the ten aspects,
the four fearlessnesses and the unshared qualities,
loving-kindness and great compassion:
through the mantra of a single vowel,
may all manner of suffering be perfectly stilled,
may captivating wealth and lordship be granted,
may many forms of might and power be produced,
may stable abiding be attained, may definitive meaning be attained,
and may the supreme vajra awakening mind be aroused.

In brief, so that the minds of whoever desires whatever
may be fulfilled according to their wish —
Sharpen the unsurpassed vajra,
Proclaim the unsurpassed sound of Dharma,
Turn the unsurpassed wheel,

Take up the unsurpassed sword,
Grasp the unsurpassed lotus,
Make the unsurpassed jewel shine bright.
Having elaborated in the manner of a maṇḍala,
then condense it in the manner of a reliquary shrine.
Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters),
asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras,
rākṣasas, flesh-eaters, the hosts of forgetfulness —

Transform these many emanations
into something that strikes terror even in the terrifying.
The moment that supreme voice is heard,
Vajrapāṇi, the greatly powerful,
joyfully joins his palms together
and makes this supplication in pleasing words:

From gold and the five precious substances
arises the supremely excellent jewel-mountain,
which is the support and dwelling place of all beings
and is held as their true sign and symbol.
By fully purifying consciousness
and the four aggregates and the four elements,
those who know mantras, having taken up
the deities, mudrās, and enlightened activities,
will come to possess the sequential path of gnosis
of discipline and awakening, distinguished and supreme.

Then the Blessed One, the great Sage,
supreme among the most excellent, the lord of omniscient gnosis,
sent forth from his body many rays of light,
brilliant and radiant in various hues.
When those rays pervaded all the fields
adorned with their foundations, their cores, and their flowers,
the earth trembled in six ways,
the world-protectors and the hosts of māras
all fell into a swoon without exception,
the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas trembled with fear,
and the assembled hosts of wise bodhisattvas
were utterly filled with awe.

At that moment, from the ten directions' fields,
from the hair pore-reliquaries (Skt. ūṛṇā-koṣas) of all the buddhas,
the hosts of the great wrathful ones arose,
drawn by the tip of the light-ray,
and gathered here in this maṇḍala at the center of the field.
The assembled mass of light rays then converged
and dissolved into the auspicious vase.
At that moment, from the blessing of that light,
this sound rang out through the sky:

"All the sons of the Victors who have arisen
from the dharmadhātu — come every one
to where the Sage, the perfected buddha, protector of the Śākyas,
dwells in his great splendor.
Having heard the supreme, stainless, sacred Dharma
and the virtuous way of practice in secret mantra,
may you reach the unconditioned awakening
and attain the Protector of the World."

Then the entire assembly of Vajrapāṇi and his retinue,
the whole of the assembled maṇḍala,
cupped their hands, filled them with flowers,
scattered them in offering, made prostrations, and circumambulated.
With clear and reverent manner,
kneeling with palms joined, they made this supplication:

"O supreme great gnosis that does not abide at any extreme,
O chief source from which an ocean of qualities arises,
O great Sage fully adorned with all defining marks,
who has relinquished all that bears no mark —
what is that stainless virtue?
What is the mode of practice in secret mantra?
What is that unconditioned awakening?
How does one become the Protector of the World?
As the supreme medicine for us
and in your great compassion for all beings,
O Protector, O Blessed One, O great Sage,
please explain this again and again."

Then the perfectly and fully awakened one,
supreme among the two-legged, declared:
"O Vajradhara, lord of secrets,
you who are endowed with the eye of great wisdom,
in order to strive for the benefit of self and other —
listen well and hold it in your mind.
The way of being perfectly and truly at the ultimate —
I shall now explain this.

Taking life, taking what is not given, lying, sexual misconduct,
harsh speech, divisiveness, idle chatter,
covetous intent, harmful intent, wrong view, and intoxicants,
foul-smelling and unclean food and drink,
the flesh and blood of living creatures, and wrong livelihood —
the guru, the Saṅgha, stūpas, and so forth,
and in particular the possessions and implements of worthy recipients,
stealing from those who are lowly and impoverished,
selling texts, exploiting the Dharma for profit,
weapons such as swords, poisons, and the like —
seeing these as you would a pit of fire, abandon them,
and practice every form of whiteness of conduct.

Writing, making offerings and gifts,
listening, retaining, reading,
making offerings, reciting,
and with the mind reflecting and meditating upon these —
strive in the ten white paths for a long time
with ability, without interruption.

The awakening mind that lacks all fixation
is pure and stainless as crystal.
By practicing this supreme path, one severs
the mass of suffering swiftly — it is virtue.

The selflessness of phenomena, equality,
and the original primordial purity of one's own mind,
the absence of cause, result, and conditioning factors,
and freedom from defiled happiness —
from these arise, without exception,
all the qualities that are wings of awakening."

The conduct of the selflessness of phenomena is this: by making the wisdom of the dharmadhātu manifest, the unmixed phenomena are perfectly and clearly present — this is the unconditioned awakening, the very ground and body of all phenomena.

In the desire realm and the other realms, one engages in enjoyment, delighting thoroughly in their qualities. This is the secret, hidden from buddhas and non-Buddhists alike. For immeasurable, inconceivable eons, the vast, profound, and extensive trainings difficult to practice — mantras, mudrās, and meditative absorptions dwelling in body, speech, and mind — because they protect in an inseparable manner, all the buddhas declare this to be mantra.

The form endowed with the major and minor marks, perfect in all qualities, dwelling in the two truths — this is the protector of the bodhisattvas. For some it appears as the form of a wheel-turning king, for some as the form of a great ascetic, for some as the form of a rākṣasa or rākṣasī, for some as the form of a virtuous being. Turning the wheel of Dharma, gazing like a lion, and performing many diverse acts — for the two-footed ones, asuras, and the rest of the two divisions and so on, one has become the protector of all beings.

Those conceived by a mind of a Lord who is permanent, similar, and without certainty — such are the protectors of ordinary worldly people. Distinguished by form, appearance, and color, varied in land, time, and manifestation, they are worthy of worship beyond number.

The moment the Sage had spoken, Vajrapāṇi rose up, made prostrations and circumambulation, and then, seated before him, spoke these words: "O Blessed One, foremost guide, what exactly is what is called mantra? What is the nature of what is called mudrā? How is meditative absorption explained? How do they dwell in body, speech, and mind? How does one protect in an inseparable manner? For the sake of benefit to myself and out of love for others, please explain."

Then the foremost Victor, supreme among victors, extended the power of his tongue, and with the melodious voice of the great Brahmā, in order to exhaust conceptual thought, declared this:

"Essence-mantra, proximate essence, and root mantra — these are the activity mantras. Essence is what is to be recited, and seed. Proximate essence is known as supreme wisdom, and also as the secret essence. Activity mantras are two: the activity mantra that stabilizes one's own nature, and that which accomplishes the assemblage of preparatory practices.

Mudrā is the movement of the formations of the hands, and the change of stance of the feet. Because it symbolizes, seals, and renders unchangeable, it is explained as mudrā.

When one gathers the mind to single-pointedness, and through this brings superior phenomena down upon the mind — that is called meditative absorption.

Thus, relying upon these, as one's former condition is wholly transformed, this body — like a fine-winged bird freed from its egg — soars greatly into the sky. In all the buddha-fields of the Victors, hearing the true Dharma from the Victors, one then expounds it to all the sons of the Victors. And through a knowledge that cognizes in a single instant, knowing objects filling every direction without remainder — this abides in body, speech, and mind.

When mind and mentation merge, wisdom arises in a blissful manner. This is what all the buddhas of the three times have declared: protect in an inseparable manner."

This concludes the first chapter, the chapter setting forth the meaning of superior abiding, extracted from the tantra known as the Compendium of Awareness of the noble Vajrakrodharāja, King of the Wrathful Vajra.

In order to tame great obstructing forces difficult to subdue through peaceful means, and to tame those who lead beings astray, having understood the distinctions of their minds from within the heart, and in order to overpower those by assuming the same form — remaining on the conceptual-thought-free path of space, the form that tames those difficult to tame — the fully awakened one, supremely noble, wrathful, of great power and glory, son of the sons of all the buddhas: to that one whose name is famed as Immovable, victors and sons of victors here constantly make prostrations. Brahmā and all the gods and every embodied being constantly make offerings to that one.

Performed by the victors, sustained by the sons of the victors, the fulfillment of aspirations, inconceivable —

Having perfected gnosis, one attains the ground of the Immovable;
by that attainment one is called Immovable.

A hero who vanquishes adversarial opponents —

the wrathful one is the one who cuts them down completely.

Through the unfailing true words of mantra,

the hosts of māras and śrāvakas cannot move him.
Victorious through wrath, free of conceptual thought, toward māra —
through miraculous power he is Immovable, beyond all motion.

The supreme essence of suchness,
the body of the Victor arisen from emptiness:
abiding in the very nature of dharmadhātu,
this emanation purifies the realms of conditioned existence.

Like space, stainless and free of conceptual elaboration,
all the buddhas of the three times arise from it.
In the nature of space, free of elaboration,
what is called secret mantra is only a conventional designation —
yet it transcends the domain of speech.
The Protector taught it for the sake of understanding through convention.

Mind-free, nature-free, emptiness —
one meditates upon it with the mind as though upon an illusion.
The goals one desires — beautifully equal, without substantiality —
are granted by the proclamation of this lord of secret mantra.

The non-Buddhists hold to self, life-force, person,
a primal cause, and a supreme being pervading all existence —
deluded and arrogant, clinging to cyclic existence as permanent,
bound by the snare of error, they generate suffering.

There is no self, no life-force, no sentient being,
no agent, no primal cause,
no all-pervading ground, no substantial thing,
no perfect inherent nature in matter.

In order to cut the snare of erroneous views that bind to existence,
one meditates on forms of various kinds, without substantiality.
Through release from the substantial, one attains the level of emptiness,
cultivating familiarity with that distinction between outer and inner.

Meditate on the head as a water-bubble, as though an illusion.
Arising from emptiness through meditative absorption,
freed from the binding of conceptual thoughts and misdeeds,
one attains the level of deathless gnosis.

No aggregates, no elements, no sense bases,
no all-base consciousness, and no person,
no apprehended and apprehender, no bondage —
so the Victors constantly teach.

Without anything, parted from everything, abandoning everything:
if with diligence one constantly meditates on emptiness, bodhicitta, and the
likeness of an illusion,
the sprout of the awakening mind will arise.

Like a wish-fulfilling jewel, of great miraculous power,
a body like space, unstained and unobstructed —
a bodhisattva who engages in mantra practice
thereby attains meditation upon the awakening mind.

What is proclaimed as wondrous, and upon hearing it straightaway,
one offers praise to the chief of the wrathful ones:

Constantly pure and stainless,
the stream of conceptual thought cut off, free of all mental proliferation —
to the great hero who has entered beyond examination and thought,
I bow down and offer praise.

You, for whom all phenomena are unmoved,
who has perfectly refined every domain of activity —
the omniscient one, ever unmoved,
whose nature is free of elaboration: to you I bow down.

For the sake of benefiting the many various sentient beings,
various forms of conduct and activity have been taught.
The paths of purity arise perfectly and completely
from the pure mind: to that I bow down and offer praise.

Like clear sky, pure and parted from clouds,
having abandoned the finest particle of darkness —
you, the Protector, whose body is like a crystal sphere,
free of all conceptual proliferations: to you I bow down and offer praise.

Like space free of elaboration,
utterly parted from all substantial things —
the aggregates, elements, and sense bases utterly purified:
to the ocean of gnosis I bow down and offer praise.

Like a rainbow appearing in manifold colors in the sky,
you, the chief, behold beings with a pure mind.
The great hero arisen to liberate all beings from the lower realms,
arrayed in great armor: to you I bow down and offer praise.

The essence arisen from the nature of reality,
the single syllable of great splendor —
dispelling the dense darkness upon the ground of beings' suffering:
to that I bow down and offer praise.

By this secret teaching of the supreme mantra's lord,
it is said that the sons of the Victor increase Dharma and give rise to wisdom,
and swiftly approach the unsurpassable level.
To you, the lord, I bow down and offer praise.

Liberated from karma and birth — from all that is conditioned and subject to
change —
the Victor, arisen as a self-cause without any cause:
to you, supreme lord, I bow down and offer praise.

With the flame of gnosis, without substantiality,
having burned all the mountains of conditioned phenomena,
victorious in the single nature of dharmadhātu —
to the unsurpassable body I bow down and offer praise.

Having understood the meaning of the praise, he taught the ritual for the
benefit of beings.

From the wrong practice of secret mantra and from habituating oneself
wrongly to miserliness, from mental ideation overpowered by desire, mantra
practitioners are reborn in the realm of hungry ghosts.

At the first stage, such a being interrupts offerings of butter lamps, flowers,
food, tormas, cakes, garlands, and the like — the substances and implements of
worship, human bodies, and food. It causes harm and gives rise to unpleasant
illness, and brings harm to the crops.

At the second stage, having become a fierce yakṣa, it roams about craving
flesh, blood, and alcohol; it interrupts hearing, reflection, and practice; it gives
rise to illness, steals life-force, and produces wrong views.

In order to vanquish the spirit-possession that bears the knowledge mantra,
the practitioner should exert himself and recite the mantra. By the
suppression-rite, with the mantra's power generated through tormas, fire

offering, mudrā, and mantra — like a forest fire — they are vanquished without obstacle.

The gods are what stabilize those, and the maṇḍala diagrams are what illuminate them. What purifies all of them utterly — the supreme, peaceful bodhicitta — to the churning mass of wrong-conceptualized saṃsāra is like the blade of a sharp sword.

This is the second chapter, the chapter on suchness, from the tantra known as The Condensed Points of the Noble Vajra Wrathful King.

Then the mantras and mudrās shall be thoroughly explained as they arise.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: Hūṃ. This is the heart essence.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: sarva-thā caṇḍa-mahāroṣaṇa-sphoṭaya hūṃ, ṭa-ṭa-haṃ-maṃ. This is the essence.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: hṛata, amogha, caṇḍa-mahāroṣaṇa-sphoṭaya hūṃ, tramaya hūṃ, ṭa-ṭa-haṃ-maṃ. This is the near essence.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: acalārkaṇa, naṭṭa-naṭṭa, moṭṭa-moṭṭa, saṭṭa-saṭṭa, taṭṭa-taṭṭa, tiṣṭha-tiṣṭha, āveśa aḥ, maṭṭa, malaka, dhaṇa-dhaṇa, tiṇi-tiṇi, khāda-khāda, vighnān, māra-māra-duṣṭan, rakṣa-rakṣa-satvaṃ, kuru-kuru, kiri-kiri, mahā-vijaya-vajra phaṭ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, tri-vilata-rāga, nartaka, haṃ-haṃ-haṃ, acala, tece, phaṭ-phaṭ, a-hūṃ, asamanta-ka, ṭa-ṭa, mahā-bala-sātāmanaya, traṃ-maṃ-haṃ, śūrya-duloka, tuṣyantu-loka-vajrī, namas-svā-pratihata-vale-bhyo, jala-matra-ta, asata namas-svāhā. This is the secret essence.

Then, the mantras to be recited together with mudrā and posture are taught here:

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: oṃ hana-hana māra-māra-yajñāna, khaḍga hūṃ phaṭ. This is the mantra of the sword mudrā.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: oṃ gṛhṇa-gṛhṇa, khāda-khāda, pāśana, bandha-bandha, mahate, dharmate svāhā. This is the lasso mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ rakṣa-rakṣa, hana-hana, kuṭṭa-kuṭṭa, mārayā-duṣṭa-vināyakaṃ hūṃ jaḥ.
This is the armor mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ dhara-dhara vajra-nali, khaṭvāṃga-pāśa-dhara svāhā. This is the uṣṇīṣa
mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ bhañja-bandha-daha-paca-bhasmi-kuru-kuru-hana-hana vajra, gr̥ṇa-gr̥ṇa
phaṭ. This is the club mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ ṣaṭ-na-ta-mūrti, daha-daha, sādahaya-sādahaya, vijaya-vijaya,
vijaya-kīrtisāhā. This is the head mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ bhu-dhara-dhara, acintyabala-vikramaṇaṃ, bura-busa-laya,
rakṣa-rakṣa-sarva svāhā.

This is the stone mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ vajra-hṛdaya, vajra-mataṃgi svāhā. This is the heart mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ hūṃ daha-daha, kiṃcirāyasi, ānaya śīghraṃ, rakṣa-rakṣa, bandha-bandha,
duṣṭaṃ, dama-dama svāhā. This is the direction-binding mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ duna-duna, mahā-pāśa-khaṭvāṃgha-dhāra-sapari-pūrake svāhā. This is the
seal-of-command mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ gagana-gandhodbhava, mahā-samaya, paripūrake svāhā. This is the
incense mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ viśuddha-jñāna-rāji-saṃbhava gaganānāṃ hāḥ svāhā. This is the
offering-spirit mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ śuddha-dharmate, śuddha-śuddha, gr̥ṇa-gr̥ṇa,
sarva-sapari-pūrakebhyaḥ svāhā. This is the torma mudrā mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ śuddha-mahā-jñāna-svabhāve, tiṣṭha-tiṣṭha, mahā-naye svāhā. This is the incense mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ gagana-vikrānta-gāmani, mahā-śuddha-naye svāhā. This is the flower mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ hana-hana, parama-viśuddhe-dharma-naya-paripūrakebhyaḥ svāhā. This is the food-offering mantra.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ apratihita-nadyata, dama-dama, sarva-sapari-pūrakebhyaḥ svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the heroes.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ piśuddha-viśuddha, sakra-svabhāve ānaya, mahā-naye svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the bodhisattvas.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ viśuddha svāhā, hana-hana, dama-dama, mahā-naye svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the śrāvakas.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ vajrākarṣaya, śīghraṃ, daha-daha, paca-paca, mahā-parivāra svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the male and female messengers.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ matha-matha, ānaya-ānaya, praveśaya-praveśaya, sarva-tathāgata-sarva-devanta-mata-mata, mahā-naya-parivāri hūṃ svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the worldly ones.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ satya-satya, mahā-sādhaya, dama-dama, mahā-dama, ākarṣaya-ākarṣaya, adya-va-mahā-naya-śuddhe svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the sages.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ jaya-jaya, vijaya-vijaya, mahā-satya-padini, sarva-hite svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the sisters.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way:
oṃ hri-hādā, matha-matha, dama-dama, hana-hana, mahā-naye, mara-mara, ha svāhā. This is the mantra for inviting the offering spirits.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: om̐ hana-vajra hūṃ phaṭ, sarva-duṣṭa-grahaṃ, matha-matha, bhañja-bhañja, sarva-vighnaṃ, dama-dama, sarva-duṣṭaṃ om̐ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. This is the mantra of the footstool offering.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: om̐ āḥ hūṃ, ākāśa-gagana-spharaṇa khaṃ svāhā.

The torma laden with milk-broth, grain of many kinds, incense and flowers and the rest, whatever has been gathered and assembled — with this mantra it is to be multiplied and expanded.

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: om̐ svabhāva sarva-tā-bhyo bāṃ svāhā. Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: om̐ landhe sarva-gagana-labdha svāhā. Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: om̐ sarva-siddhi dvādhāmi haṃ svāhā.

This is the mantra for transforming all as the blessing dictates, for causing everything to be absorbed, and for accomplishing whatever activities are desired.

The mantra of the eight great planets, the lunar mansions, and the twenty-eight constellations:

Homage to all the fully accomplished ones, to all the Tathāgatas, in every way: Āditya, Soma, Aṅgāra, Budha, Bṛhaspati, Śukra, Śanaiścara, Rāhu, Ketu, Kṛttikā, Rohiṇī, Mṛgaśīrā, Ārdrā, Punarvasu, Puṣya, Āśleṣā, Maghā, Pūrva-Phālgunī, Uttara-Phālgunī, Hasta, Citrā, Svāti, Viśākhā, Anurādhā, Jyeṣṭhā, Mūla, Pūrvāṣāḍhā, Uttarāṣāḍhā, Śravaṇā, Abhijit, Śatabhiṣā, Dhaniṣṭhā, Pūrva-Bhādrapadā, Uttara-Bhādrā, Revatī, Aśvinī, Bharaṇī —

each preceded by om̐ and followed by svāhā: these are the seed-mantra of each one respectively. They may be joined to whatever activity is desired, and the category of offering should be distinguished accordingly.

Homage to the vajras of body, speech, and mind of all directions: om̐ acala kaṇa caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa sphoṭaya tra-ka-kha haṃ māṃ. Homage to the vajras of body, speech, and mind of all directions: om̐ vajra-kapa-ca duṃ baṃ. om̐, homage to all the Tathāgatas, to all the dispellers of fear, to those of universal face, protect everything everywhere — O great and mighty one, by the merit

of all the Tathāgatas, hūṃ hūṃ trāṭha, unobstructed, svāhā.

The wrathful one with a single fierce eye,
together with his retinue, receives the offering.

Through reciting the mantra and receiving the siddhi, accomplishment is gained.

Apply the ritual procedure to whatever activity you wish.

Now the mudrās are as follows.

Right hand: extend the middle finger flat, then straighten it. Press the ring finger and little finger down with the thumb. Draw force inward, release in the gesture of drawing out, and cast it upward through space. The sword mudrā destroys the hosts of māras.

Left hand: make a fist, raise the index finger, and rotate it — this is the lasso mudrā. Bring the middle finger and little finger together separately. Bend the ring finger inward. Press the thumb flat against the side of the middle finger. Placed at the heart center: the armor mudrā. Clasp the fingers in a fist, closed inward. Turn the two thumbs slightly: the skull mudrā.

Place the thumb of the left fist inside the right fist, then raise the right thumb upright — this is the hammer mudrā. Strike as if pounding in the ten directions.

Right fist: raise the middle finger. Place this mudrā at the crown of the head — the crown mudrā. Left fist: raise the middle finger. Always brandish this — the command-seal mudrā.

Press both fists flat together at the belly — this is the stone mudrā. Place the right fist at the heart center — this is the heart-adornment mudrā.

Extend both hands with fingers spread out individually — this is the mudrā of binding the ten directions.

Press the palms together with both middle fingers placed inside — this is described as the incense mudrā.

Fists back to back, middle finger and thumb touching, ring finger hooking around — this is the tormā-offering mudrā.

Cup the hollow of the palms like a sheath and present them — this is the incense-offering mudrā.

Both hands separately, middle and ring fingers bent, thumbs pressing down, placed, extended — the flower mudrā. Palms joined, middle and ring fingers

bent, little finger and index finger extended — the food mudrā.

Sit in the cross-legged posture, hold the grip, bend both thumbs inward, cross and interlock the fingers, then fan outward — this is the mudrā for inviting the chief hero.

Press the palms together, bend the fingers, press with the thumbs — this is the mudrā for summoning the assembly of bodhisattvas.

Form the grip, press the little fingers flat and extend them, then bend each of the remaining eight fingers separately — this is the mudrā for summoning without exception all śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and those with miraculous powers.

Place the right fist on top of the left, extend the two index fingers separately and curve them slightly — this is the mudrā for summoning male and female messengers.

Form fists with the backs outward, then extend the middle fingers separately and straighten them; bring the two thumbs slightly together and draw inward — this is the mudrā for summoning worldly beings. Do the same but with the right hand rather than the left — this is the mudrā for summoning ascetics and sages who hold vows. Raise the middle finger of the left fist — this is the mudrā for summoning the sisters of accomplishment (the ḍākinīs of siddhi).

Extend the right hand flat and open; press the three fingers with the thumb and fan them — this will summon the seven mothers and all the mātṛkās at the time of ritual activity.

Raise the knees alternately in a straight posture and press the soles of the feet to the knees; join the palms with flowers at the crown of the head, fan them toward that direction, and gaze with a piercing stare. With this circular posture, all these subdue the hosts of obstructing spirits and protect the yogin.

Extend the right hand upward; point the index finger of the left hand at the heart; press the two feet together and strike the heel; recite Hūṃ aloud in a fierce voice and gaze forward. In the crescent-moon posture that shakes the three levels of the earth, and in the posture with the left leg extended, recite Ha Ha, seal the step-mudrā, cross the hands upon one another, and drive them against the obstructing spirits. Then open the wheel-mudrā.

In the posture with the right leg extended, thrust the vajra-joined palms upward into space; with wrathful furrowed brows, press the lips, and extend each pair of limbs like fire. In the posture of even feet with the sound of Hūṃ,

the mudrā of the two index fingers is the seal. From the posture of both feet placed evenly, turn the right around the left at the navel; to the front with the right, to the rear with the left — pressing three and three at the joints is the triple-point, and that is the triple-point mudrā.

Extend the hand upward and raise the club; drive it against the obstructing spirits and gaze with a piercing stare. Strike with the mallet on the right while reciting Hūṃ; point the index finger of the left hand at the heart. Both together, spread wide — perform the wheel. Face west, feet placed evenly; right to the front, rear and left direction — with the left hand press the three obstructing spirits. In sequence: the mudrā of fire, the sword, the index-finger snare, binding in all four directions; recite Ha Hūṃ loudly — the mudrā of overpowering majesty.

Embrace both knees and turn both fists; pressed with a line, this subdues. To expel the obstructing spirits, gaze with a piercing stare. Cut off in the single-pointed vajra posture. Rotate the right and left feet alternately: south and north with the left, east and west with the right — extend and strike hard. From behind: straight on, the mallet, the vajra, and the lasso-mudrā — perform these in the four directions. With the wheel posture, the mudrā, and the dance posture, even the guardians of the directions are terrified — how much more so the hosts of elemental spirits! All are brought under control.

Then the distinctive dance postures for binding the ten directions shall be explained.

To the east, with the feet placed evenly, strike the vajra-joined palms upward. To the south, press the heels together with the sound Ga, roar Hūṃ, and join the palms front and back. To the west, press the feet together and extend the two index fingers of both hands separately upward. To the north, perform the sword-mudrā, raise one foot from the ground, press the fist to the forehead with the fingers joined, place both feet together and raise them alternately; gnash the teeth, roar Hūṃ, and gaze wrathfully — this is the mudrā renowned as the bindu of the northeast.

Form the fist with the little finger and fang — this is the mudrā of the fang. Raise the feet alternately; open toward the east and south. To the southwest, strike both feet alternately. Strike with the lasso and cut with the sword. To the northwest, strike both feet and join both thumbs, rotating the wheel — or else apply the single-life mudrā. In all dance postures, roar Ha Hūṃ.

Then the mudrā and ritual procedure for repelling vidyā-mantras shall be explained.

Form the fist, extend the middle finger with its tip joining; hold the two index fingers at its sides. By all the mantras and mudrās, gods (deva), nāgas, rākṣasas, and yakṣas —

ḍākinīs, elemental spirits, and non-humans — slain and driven off as if by fire.

This is the third chapter, on mantras and mudrās, from the tantra called the Condensed Recollection of the Noble Vajra Wrathful King.

Now the ritual procedure for a supreme painted cloth image shall be explained.

For one who desires a painted image, first obtain good, clean cloth appropriate for the purpose. Wash it, protect it with mantras, and dye it saffron yellow.

The painter must be of good lineage, be calm and disciplined, have heard the Dharma, be skilled in drawing, meticulous in work, have few desires, a steady mind, and be free of anger. Apply to the cloth a sizing of lac-resin, bark extract, and alum solution.

For the colors: for green, use bronze-flower and malachite; for upper-yellow, use orpiment; for red pigment, use lapis-red, vermilion shell, and red ochre; for blue, use indigo, blue-bark, and gypsum blue; for black, use soot and añjana; for white, use śvetā chalk, which renders white. Prepare the ground of the cloth with sizing and priming. Write with the brush — finest, medium, or coarse — and choose an auspicious day: a victory day, a Saturday, a square-constellation day, a full-moon day, a sixth-lunar-day, or a day on the divine boundary. Then what is to be correctly explained at greater length:

For the virtuous painted cloth image of the Sage, at the center, beside the supreme tree of awakening, is the form of a wheel-turning king arrayed in gold, wearing saffron and adorned with the mudrā of teaching the Dharma. On either side stand two kings of beautiful lotus form, their hands cupped and filled with flowers. To the right stands the white lord of the world, robed in saffron, with palms joined in reverence.

At the lord's feet is the Immovable One with three eyes, blazing in wrath, adorned with nāgas, his upper body wrapped in elephant hide, his lower wrapped in tiger skin, bearing precious ornaments and a sacred cord, enthroned upon a red stone seat. In his hands he holds a sword and a lasso, and he stands with his left arm slightly extended.

To the left side of the principal figure stands Vajrapāṇi, blue and saffron-clad, holding a vajra and a lasso. Beneath him is the sādḥaka, kneeling and holding an incense house. At the feet of the principal figure is the Great Wrathful One — the black one who stabilizes the three realms — with both hands raised upon a jeweled throne.

The principal figure is of varied lotus form. For the purposes of worldly lordship and for the wrathful, for Vajrapāṇi and the blue of the sādḥaka — the fifth limb, a single trunk — two beautiful nāga maidens are depicted embraced in his arms, cradling them close.

This is for the purpose of peace, increase, and power.

Then the correctly explained painted image: at the center is Śākyamuni, to the right is the noble Mañjuśrī, and to the left is Vajrapāṇi.

For the cloth image intended for close practice: extremely fearsome and massive in form, with one face and four arms, adorned with nāgas, blood dripping from the mouth, tongue rolling, fangs bared, uttering the great Hrīḥ sound, with three eyes blazing like the rays of the newly risen sun, his saffron below like dark rain clouds, his body garlanded with a fresh-skull necklace, his head adorned with a crown of four skulls, on the left a jeweled side-lock hanging down. With the blazing light of the fire of the final aeon, he burns the assembled obstructing spirits of the directions.

His first right hand holds a vajra, his second holds a sword blazing with light. His first left hand holds a vajra-lasso, his second extends the threatening finger. Enthroned upon a jeweled stone seat, he presses down the king of obstructers, and abides in the dance posture of the left leg extended. Before him paint the peacemaking sādḥaka holding the incense house. Make continuous offerings of whatever is available.

Now the painted cloth image for accomplishing fierce activity shall be correctly explained.

On a charnel-ground cloth, the Immovable One — dark in color, with three eyes gazing sideways, wearing saffron robes, with wrathful furrowed brows, holding a sword and a lasso. Once the image is painted, open its eyes with one's own blood and then make supplication.

For this image, even a vidyādhara need not speak of accomplishing fierce rites. Or alternatively, for the purpose of varied activities, depicted with blue complexion, adorned with elephant hide, in the posture of extension and

contraction, holding a vajra and bell, seated upon a lotus moon — paint this image.

For the painted cloth image used in routing armies: the wrathful one of golden color, the Immovable One, his form fearsome with fangs bared, adorned with a garland of blazing flames, with four faces and four arms —

holding a sword and lasso in the first pair of hands, with a jewel and threatening gesture below, four feet pressing upon the hearts of four mārās. Following this, the painted cloth image for the accomplishment of a vidyādhara is now correctly described.

The Immovable One, wrathful, with a single face, of fair and glowing complexion, the color of a zarma flower, bearing a sword, lasso, and threatening gesture, the right knee raised and the left set just slightly into the ground — in the sky above, two divine sons fan him with relief, a form delightful to behold. To his right, paint Vairocana; to his left, Amitābha. Before him, paint the practitioner as well.

Then make offerings to all the vidyā consorts, strew flowers, and upon opening the eyes of the image, present food. Consecrate it with the auspicious-connection mantra. After that, set down the aspiration:

Om. The merit I have gathered, immeasurable and beyond reckoning — by its power, may all beings without exception attain the unsurpassed state. May whatever hell-beings, animals, and hungry ghosts there are in countless numbers — by the power of my merit — all come to possess happiness. May whatever gods and humans suffer poverty, sickness, famine, harm from enemies, and the like — by the power of my merit — be freed from all of that. As many as are all sentient beings, that many are the oceans of suffering of every kind; may all of those be stilled, and may not one of them know suffering. May all sentient beings who engage in non-virtue of body, speech, and mind be separated from it, come to engage in virtue in abundance, and all attain the state of happiness.

Then, with all the sons of the Victors assembled in prostration, taking in hand incense, flowers, and all the other articles of offering, in order to distinguish the upper and lower seats, recite these words inviting the Sugatas:

Om. Blessed Ones who are Sugatas, you who actually dwell as protectors — for the sake of compassion toward me once more, you who have power over the Victors and their sons — go forth to accomplish your aims, and out of

compassion, come again.

Then, so as not to harm the accomplishment and the samaya, do not touch with the hand the torma, the flowers, the incense, the maṇḍala ornaments, and the colored powders. Instead, using a cloth whisk and the like, sweep them up comfortably, recite the mantra of unborn and unceasing reality, and cast everything into a river. Then cook rice, milk, meat, sugar, and butter together, and together with the rice-dish, hold a feast for the Saṅgha and for brahmins so as to generate joy.

Thereafter, keep the painted image in a secret place and worship it there. In particular, worship it on the eighth day of each month. Present offerings to the lama. Always please every mantra-holder without exception and do not cause them displeasure. Turn away from sentient beings who lack faith. Generate certainty in the Three Jewels, and abandon doubt and laziness.

To attend to one's own aggregates: bathe and keep oneself clean; wear unsoiled, spotless garments. Eat foods such as rice — those that are pure and without impurity — in small measure, drinking likewise. Eating too much produces sleep, laziness, and bad smell. Rise at the very first light of dawn and strive until late into the night. When sleeping at the middle of the night, lie down with the intention to benefit beings.

This is the fourth chapter — the chapter on painted images — from the tantra entitled "The King of Wrathful Vajra, the Noble One: A Summary of His Topics."

Then, the sequence of deity meditation to be correctly explained: having made one's own form empty, from the garland of letters of the syllable circle, as sound resonates, the great vidyā appears like the reflection of the moon. Abiding therein are the vajra and so forth — these are precisely one's own mudrā. From that arises the supreme body, just as a rainbow appears, perfectly endowed with the major marks, minor marks, radiance, and light.

Possessed of a majestic and delighted countenance,
with the bearing and adornments of sport and grace,
like the youthful bloom of a child and young one,
with jeweled ornaments and fine clothing —
the form is beautiful, as a god appears;
yet also like a furious rākṣasa.

The hair, beard, and all the body hair
are tawny and coarse, and curled.

The various charnel-ground ornaments

are rough, and the mind within is supremely wrathful.
The clothing, wet with blood,
is made to drape in the upper portion.
With the roar of "Ha ha, hūṃ hūṃ, phaṭ phaṭ,"
the battle cry like thunder, with the melody of the cuckoo,
the body is adorned with the swaying gait
that trembles as though shaking a hundred thousand Mount Merus,
radiantly embracing, uttering the sound "phuṭ,"
with a maṇḍala of emanating and gathering light
like a hundred thousand suns, like the fire at the end of an eon.
Exceedingly fierce, with many weapons,
as in the turmoil of the asuras at the time of battle,
the hosts of wrathful gods and wrathful goddesses arise,
all bearing the syllable hūṃ as their sound.
The Mothers and the ḍākinīs
have as their essential nature the fierce syllable bhrūṃ.
The Mighty One generates them from the syllable muṃ;
the bodhisattvas, wisdom consorts, śrāvakas,
and worldly protectors are generated by this mantra.

Namaḥ sarvatathāgatebhyaḥ, saparivarākebhyaḥ, sarvathā, oṃ
sarvasaṃskārapariśuddhe, dharmate gaganasamudgate svabhāvapariśuddhe,
mahānayaparivāre svāhā.

Having directed the mind to one's own body,
all wrongdoing is utterly pacified.
Having arisen perfectly in excellent conduct,
dwelling in mind that has become knowing and aware,
one becomes a sage (ṛṣi) endowed with miraculous power.
Furthermore, if one can pacify the suffering of others,
what need is there to speak of gaining one's own happiness?

The image, hand-symbol, and color
of the deities of one's own respective family or clan —
from the maṇḍala or from the painted image —
are to be meditated upon as they have been taught.

Then, the great Immovable Wrathful One,
having paid homage to Vajradhara,

with words pure, clear, and pleasing,
spoke also these words in supplication:
"O Vajradhara, Blessed One,
you who are perfectly endowed with the characteristics of the Fierce One —
describe to me now my own characteristics."

Thereupon the Victorious Vajra-Holder King,
having taken on the form adorned with the attributes of the Fierce One,
together with his own form and mantra,
proclaimed this great secret symbol:

The pure mind itself is the hūṃ-vajra.
From the deep blue color arises Vajradhara.
Deep blue, extended and contracted, a being of wrathful mind,
bearing ornaments of bone, the body that causes terror.
With upswept hair and beard, wearing tawny red,
dwelling upon a lotus and moon seat,
residing amid fire, holding vajra and bell.
Vairocana and the holder — these are the first two;
the third of the fifth, the fifth of the fourth;
the fifth of the fifth, the fourth of the seventh —
pressed down by drawing in the seed syllable of fire.
The first of the seventh is the third;
raised by the third. With hūṃ and phaṭ.

This supreme, unsurpassed king of secret mantras
accomplishes every aim,
and in particular dispels elemental spirits.
In taming nāgas there is great white,
and great bearing in the form of Garuḍa.
For the purpose of the treasure of accomplishment,
there is yellow endowed with light;
there are the pure reds, greens, and blacks,
for dispelling fierce possessing spirits,
and for the auspiciousness of long life.

The supreme body of the supreme generated form —
the very instant it arises,
all the earth below is shrouded in dense darkness,

and all the māras are utterly scorched.
This great fire-light of primordial wisdom —
there is not one who can easily endure it.
Those who are the great obstructors, the misleaders,
flee far off with minds full of dread.

The secret mantra, the syllable bearing the sound hūṃ,
is like the rays of crackling lightning.
At the crown there is the form of the syllable hrīḥ,
with the triangular image of fire.
With blazing red light scattered and burst forth,
the hosts of obstructors are burned and caused to flee.

Those bearing the forms of she-ass, dog, and monkey,
along with all zombies without exception,
cry out "Ha ha!" and flee —
like dust scattered by the wind.

Above and below, the emanating and gathering of hūṃ;
the ten wrathful ones, the seed syllable hūṃ,
blazes in the manner of fire and wind —
like fire on dry grass, manifest and direct.

Passing beyond the hūṃ at the heart,
the hūṃ at the crown burns all away.
Light, mudrā (seal), and the divine body —
reflect upon driving out, binding, and bewildering.

Like a lion, a great elephant, a dragon,
with whatever fierce sounds and roars resound —
reciting the root secret mantra,
all obstructors and false guides without exception
are burned and ground to dust.

Revealing the essence within the heart,
the blazing light with its radiance
utterly destroys the many hosts of sins.

Through the vow-wheel mantras of body, speech, and mind,
joined with om̐, āḥ, and hūṃ,
splendor increases and lordship is engendered,
and the great armor is donned.

Namastreyādhikānāṃ tathāgatānāṃ haṃ.

This mantra of the great armor —
if even the sons of the Victors tremble at it,
what need is there to say that obstructors are burned?

Through samayastvaṃ ahaṃ,
let connection with the wisdom deity be established.
Through the empowerment and union conferred by the Victors,
the wisdom crown ornament is to be examined.

At the crown is the motionless one bearing the crown ornament;
upon all the retinue, the unshakeable seal is impressed.

Making oneself into a syllable,
through a very subtle form of fire,
one practices at the time of night.
Wrath arises from the sound of hūṃ.

This concludes the fifth chapter of the Compendium of Reasonings of the noble
Vajra Wrathful King tantra, the chapter on the arising of the deity.

Then again, what is to be correctly explained —
listen to the ritual procedure for mantra practice.

One who is without devotion,
who has not generated the awakening mind (bodhicitta),
who has not obtained empowerment or permission,
who is devoid of vows, discipline, and samaya —
such a person taking up mantra for themselves
is like a child swallowing iron that has been scorched in fire.

In order to cleanse beginningless obscurations,
the vajra master speaks thus:

Oṃ — the supreme mantra, the pure water of samādhi,
purifies the hosts of sins accumulated over many eons
and makes the mind naturally pure.

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-vajra-adhiṣṭhāna-kāya-vāk-citta-viśodhana-abhiṣiṅga
hūṃ.

Oṃ — this crown ornament, arisen from the precious mantra
supremely praised by all the buddhas,
this divine crown of jewels —

through it the supreme precious empowerment is conferred.

Oṃ vajradhara śrī-vajra-samayastvaṃ ahaṃ. Ratna-mukuṭa-abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

The great vajra, unsurpassed —
by taking it up, one is victorious over all directions.
It makes one firm as a vajra;
therefore hold it always.

Oṃ sarva-vajra-abhiṣiñci hūṃ.

The bell of unsurpassingly melodious sound —
by fully awakening the vajra of the body,
hold it always as well,
and you shall become sovereign over the three realms.

Oṃ samaya-ghaṇṭā-vajra-abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

Oṃ — the seal of compassion and wisdom inseparably united:
whoever hears it inwardly
shall become the lord bearing that very name.
Abide in the state of permanence; take it up.

Oṃ vajra-nāma-abhiṣekata.

The bodhisattva without beginning or end,
Vajrasattva of great joy,
Samantabhadra, lord of all —
let the master of the vajra pride make me himself.

The bell-seal of all the buddhas,
spoken of as following the melody of wisdom —
if you hold it always,
the Victors have proclaimed that supreme awakening is attained.

Oṃ — the peerless sword of wisdom:
whoever wields it becomes victorious;
having routed the armies of Māra,
gnosis blazes as light in the sky.

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-vajra-jñāna-khaḍga-abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

A — the vajra lasso, full of compassion:
the trunks of affliction and cyclic existence —
having bound them with the lasso of skillful means,

liberate all from the bonds of existence.

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-vajra-pāśena-abhiṣiṅca hūṃ.

One who has not obtained empowerment or permission,
who does not possess the samaya vows,
and who does not please the guru —
their practice yields no fruit, and they proceed to the lower realms.

Whoever holds wrong views and harms the guru
is certain to proceed to the hell realms.

One who transgresses these in this life
will perpetually be afflicted by disease, plague,
enemies, foes, and famine.

The maṇḍala ground should be delightful:
a riverbank, a lakeside, a mountain valley,
a grove of fruit trees and flowers,
a pleasure garden, a noble mansion,
a crossroads, a mountain ravine, a solitary tree,
a cowshed, a multi-storied building, an elephant stable,
a temple, a monastery,
a river island, a small lakeside hollow, a ford —
in such places one performs the approach practices and empowerment
ceremonies,
and accomplishes the rites in charnel grounds and the like.

The activity maṇḍala is one cubit across.

For the great empowerment maṇḍala,
the maṇḍala of the Sage is foursided —
it may also be made with six or eight sides.

Other maṇḍalas are to be made three cubits in measure,
or they may be five or seven cubits.

The planetary maṇḍala is two cubits,
or it may be made one and a half or three.

Everywhere, the palace occupies one fourth,
and the surrounding wall is half the measure of the palace;
the second structure is three quarters.

The ramp, the vajra, and the lotus —
the divine garments make up exactly four parts.

The gates of the Sage's maṇḍala are four;
otherwise, a single gate is also appropriate.
The northern gate belongs to Mañjuśrī of gentle melody.
The Dharma and the western gate belong to Vajra;
the southern gate to Vajra.
The eastern gate is for the planetary deities, world protectors, and the like.

At the sites of the sovereign deities,
place a vase together with a hand seal,
or set the image with its respective hand seal.

In the center of the Sage's maṇḍala,
upon white cloth, place the begging bowl.
The central deity's seat is six finger-breadths;
the remaining seats are four finger-breadths.
They are surrounded again and again by the clan insignia.

In the north, the subjugator of the world
bears a white lotus and a raised vajra.
The sovereign, with ablution upon the crown, belongs to Maitreya.
In the east: Mañjuśrī with a blue lotus.
To the southeast: Samantabhadra with a wish-fulfilling jewel.
In the south: Vajra, Vajrapāṇi.
To the southeast of center: Space-Heart with a white lotus.
In the west: Golden Lotus, Vajradharma.
To the northwest: Earth-Heart with a red lotus.
Above and below fall Uṣṇīṣa and Surpassing Beauty.
These are the uṣṇīṣa deity and the mortar-wood deity.

In the east: Vijaya with a skull.
To the southeast: Kāmarāja with three prongs.
In the south: single-pronged vajra, Yamāntaka.
To the southwest: great-powered sword, the Truthless One.
In the west: Hayagrīva with a lotus.
In the north: Vajra-net against obstacles and enemies.
To the northwest: a blue club.
In the sovereign's zone: Acala (the Immovable One).

Behind him stand the śrāvakas:
Śāriputra and Subhūti,
Maudgalyāyana and Kāśyapa,

the Supreme Victor and the Protector of the Earth,
Aśvajit and the Lord of Cattle,
the Fierce Great Lord with a fringe,
Bharadvāja and Pūrṇa,
Ānanda, Upānanda, and Rāhula.
These are thus the sixteen hand seals.
Above the lotus is placed the begging bowl.

Next, what is to be rightly explained
is the excellent maṇḍala of Mañjuśrī.
In the center, draw a sword blazing with fire
upon a precious rocky crag.
In the north, draw the vase
bearing the vajra mark — this belongs to Maitreya.
In the east, draw
the white vajra of Samantabhadra.
In the south, draw the vajra
of the Blazing-Fire one, held in the hand of Vajrapāṇi.
In the west is the Lord of the World —
draw him radiant with white light.
The Wish-Jewel Holder of beautiful form,
draw him as sovereign upon a precious rock.
To the southeast: the vajra of the Supremely Blazing one,
resting upon a rosary-bearing lotus — draw him there.
To the southwest, draw
blazing armor of the Resplendent One.
In the wind direction, the beautiful youthful god —
draw the precious casket.
Above: the wrathful one called Daring Ascetic.
Upon the lotus, a wrathful figure.
Below: assign the wrathful king as envoy.
Upon a vajra rocky crag, draw the lasso.
The remaining wrathful deities are to be arranged as victorious
in the manner of the former ones.

The female messenger called Steadfast —
draw her curved knife in the north.
She who holds the lunar disc:

Sky-Finger Woman is in the east.

She who holds the solar disc:

Fearsome Woman is in the south.

In the western direction, draw her:

Ūrṇā Woman, who holds a jewel garland.

Upon a precious stone, draw her in the southeast.

In the southeast, she is called Obstacle-Holder Woman:

draw a flaming wheel and a vajra.

A blazing pressing-stick, rendered without truth,

a striking hammer — draw these as though in wind.

Place the Joined-Palms Night Woman within.

With the mudrā of the Lotus Treasury

and this mantra, consecrate the maṇḍala:

Namas sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva-mukhebhyaḥ, hūṃ hūṃ vaṃ vaṃ svāhā.

This is the mantra for invoking and bidding farewell,

and it is the mantra of supreme protection:

Namas sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva-viśva-mukhebhyaḥ, he he he,
ājñā-parama-rāga-gagana, āgaccha gaccha bhagavān śīghraṃ svāhā.

For the recitation of a hundred thousand repetitions, for consecration,
for accomplishing the deity, and for offering.

Now what is to be correctly explained next
is the maṇḍala of the Vajra Dharma.

In the center: the World-Magnetizer himself,
holding a red lotus.

In the east: Meaningful Lasso,
holding a blue counting rosary.

In the south: Stainless Sky —
holding a blue vajra.

In the west: the Lotus of Dance's Lordship.

In the north: Great Force of Compassion —
draw him holding a black vajra.

Wrathful Tārā with a single lock,

and Fair-Minded Woman — draw them at the edges.

The wrathful ones and the female messengers:

arrange them in order in the manner of Mañjuśrī.

Next, the maṇḍala of Vajrapāṇi
is to be correctly explained.
In the center: Vajrapāṇi himself,
holding a white vajra.
In the east: Buddha-Eye Woman.
In the south: Lotus-Holding Māmākī.
In the west: White-Robed Woman holding a garment.
In the north: Tārā holding a blue lotus.
In the four directions: Stainless Sky,
Great Force, Vajra-Pinnacle,
and she called Great Pride —
these hold the emblems of their families.

There too, as before, the wrathful ones
are to be drawn in due sequence.
In the outer portion of that maṇḍala,
the arrangement of the wrathful deities:
Goodly-Shouldered and the other vajra-holders —
draw the eight of them in the northern direction.
Holding-the-Host, Spiritual Friend, Realm-Protector,
White-Sight, Knowing the Vedas, Falsity-Free —
these eight who turn away evil: the sages in the east.
In the south: Vajra-Foe-Stake Woman,
Vajra-Hammer Fierce-Force Woman,
Horse-Ear Woman and Frowning Woman,
Zombie Woman and Iron-Fetter Woman,
and White-Sight Woman — draw these eight.
Poison-Dispelling Peacock-of-Light Woman,
Wealth-Stream Single-Lock Shoulder-Ornament Woman,
Melodious Bell-Ringing Eight Woman in the west —
all of them bear the mudrā of their own awareness.

What is to be placed at the gate directions:
the four World-Guardians of the Sage —
Śakra (Indra), Viṣṇu, the Great Lord (Śiva),
Brahmā, and Mañjuśrī — for the maṇḍala.
Victorious Woman and Conquering Woman,
Unconquerable Woman and Avalokiteśvara,
the great dark ones and Ucchuṣma,

Youth-Abductor Woman and Treasure-Holder —
the wrathful immovable one at the four gates:
the Great Black One, Joy-Maker,
Evil-Rejecter, and Lord of the Host.

For Acala's empowerment and delight:
In the center, the wrathful Acala —
his sword blazing with fire-light.
In the four directions: wrathful ones of four colors,
bearing the appearance of a wheel-turning king,
holding in the right hand vajra, jewel, and lotus,
and a crossed-vajra,
holding in the left hand a threatening finger and a lasso.
He abides upon a precious crag,
his two feet upon a lotus.

At the corners, the four wrathful women as well,
matching the principal one in graceful bearing.

Behind him, as before, draw the ten wrathful ones —
either as full figures or as a garland of mudrās.

Behind the maṇḍala portion:
ten fierce-force world-guardians,
drawn in fury with their respective retinues and awareness-emblems.

Wind a properly measured vase in cloth.
Fill it with fragrant water, and place
twelve deity-vessels, or six — either is suitable —
adorned with ornamental mouths.

A parasol, victory banner,
offering water, incense, flowers,
lamps, perfumed water, food,
flutes, cymbals, a gathering of garments,
offering-cake with fragrant water and medicine —
pleasing fragrant foods and drinks — a full assembly of offerings.
Having arranged the maṇḍala, present the offerings.

Dig into the ground to the depth of a knee,
then, free from the many faults of insects, worms, wood, stones, and the like,
fill it with earth.

On the ground smeared with the five products of the cow,
scatter and spread flowers, arrange offerings and the rest.

Invite the deity, make offerings,
then examine the dream for what is virtuous and what is not.
If the dream is auspicious, take joy in it
and make supplication to the mistress of the earth.
In particular, make offerings with the offering-cake.

"Come, son" — for you are a vessel
of the great ways of the Great Vehicle.
The rites and practices of the conduct of secret mantra
shall be properly taught to you.

Through supreme meditation on the unmoving Protector,
the source of buddhas of the three times,
incomparable primordial wisdom is obtained.
Even the Protector, Śākyamuni — the Lion of the Śākyas —
through this unrivaled practice of secret mantra
heroically vanquished the armies of Māra,
utterly terrible, with their great hosts.
To tame the world, he turned the wheel of Dharma
over all phenomena, and then passed into nirvāṇa.

So that you likewise may attain omniscience,
son, apply yourself to this with your intelligence.

Like the flower of the udumbara,
appearing only once in a hundred aeons,
or perhaps not appearing at all —
the Protector, the great Guardian of the World,
is exceedingly difficult to encounter.
And even when encountered,
the arising of the manner of a protector of secret mantra
is supremely rare — a thing of wonder.

From the terrifying great ocean of saṃsāra,
with its utterly unbearable suffering,
nothing on this earth liberates swiftly like secret mantra —
it is like a wish-fulfilling jewel.

Abandoning the fear of old age, sickness, and death;
finding in companions the fulfillment of harmonious desires;
freedom from famine, enemies, and robbers, and bliss;
the constant enjoyment of food, drink, clothing, ornaments, and wealth;
the attainment of happiness, prosperity, and abundance;
and swift awakening — for one who desires buddhahood,
strive earnestly and swiftly in the methods of secret mantra.

Just as the protectors of the three times
have determined upon awakening without fail —
that unsurpassed awakening mind, the supreme one,
I shall now generate.

The three ethical codes — the moral discipline of vows,
the moral discipline of gathering virtuous qualities,
and the moral discipline of acting for the benefit of sentient beings —
from this day forth, hold these steadfastly, supreme among all.

Generate an elevated mind toward all beings,
and present offerings to the lama with a request.
Like a wish-fulfilling jewel, the unsurpassed form —
the peaceful state of buddhahood — shall be attained.

Taking life, stealing, lying, unchaste conduct,
drinking intoxicants, singing and dancing,
wearing ornaments and perfumes, sleeping on high and great beds,
and eating in the afternoon —
on the eighth, eleventh, and fifteenth days,
and especially throughout the open sky of empty moments,
leisures and endowments are supremely rare,
the Buddha's teaching is supremely rare.
Having taken the vow, guard it without distraction,
as you would guard your very life.

Always take refuge in the Three Jewels.
Having obtained a body endowed with the happiness of gods and humans,
the states of hell-beings, animals, and hungry ghosts —
once obtained, supremely hard to escape —
never attain those again.

I, the hero who wields the sword,
who practices the secret wheel,

shall reduce to dust and fine powder
those malicious ones who transgress the command.

To take a disciple, first,
through recitation cultivate the power of the mantra.
To increase prosperity, dispatch the offering-cake.
To attain merit, exert oneself in offerings.

The lama, grounded in hearing, reflection, and meditation,
generous and tamed, skilled in the practice of Dharma,
free from illness, patient, and with great compassion,
courageous in mantra practice and possessed of wisdom —
having examined thus, take five or seven disciples
who are faithful, diligent, calm, tamed, and respectful to the lama,
who do not fear wrongdoing, are free from illness, with faculties complete,
of pleasing form, and possessed of compassion.

This is the sixth chapter, on the methods of taking a disciple,
from the Tantra of the Condensed Realization of the Noble King of Wrathful
Vajra.

And now what is to be correctly explained:
the great accomplishment of the vidyādhara.

Unequaled and supremely excellent —
listen well to what is taught in this tantra.
The human being is the first and finest jewel:
whatever accomplishment one strives for,
that very accomplishment shall come to pass —
not otherwise.

For a sword of iron or of wood,
make it four or eight finger-widths in size.
On its handle, inscribe the five family seals.
Wash it with the fragrant water of five kinds of dung,
then offer incense and flowers.
For six months recite the mantra and meditate on the wrathful one.
The sword, smoke-quelling and blazing with light —
whoever takes it up will travel through the sky-realm (khecara),
with a lifespan spanning a middle eon,
mounting every manner of divine vehicle,

traversing the buddha-fields.

A lasso of gold, silver, or copper —
or equally one of wood —
accomplishes the same.

Victory banners, jewels, horn-pendants (giū wang), parasols,
and iron hooks — accomplish all of these likewise.

To accomplish deities, carve upon a plank of poplar
the form of whatever deity one desires.

By mantra recitation alone, the deity will come before you.
Ask for whatever you wish — speak your desires aloud.

For nāgas, use nāga-kesar wood.

For yakṣas, a golden image.

For gandharvas (sattvas who subsist on fragrance), wood of the milk-tree.

For garuḍas, an image of clay.

For rākṣasas, charnel-ground wood.

For whatever figure you have fashioned, press the neck with the left foot.
Recite three hundred thousand times and the being will come before you.
When it speaks, take what you need.

Facing east, with a painted cloth image before you,
bathe three times a day and wear wet garments.

Reciting three hundred thousand times, on the eighth day of the waning moon,
offer a tormā cake to the elemental spirits.

Place a corpse upon a maṇḍala.

Seat yourself upon a precious throne.

Recite the heart-mantra one hundred thousand times — the corpse will stir.

Without fear, look into its mouth: within you will see a tongue
like a lotus opened at the center.

Cut it out, and you shall become a vidyādhara (a bearer of
knowledge-mantras).

In a divine form you shall traverse
the realms of the world of Brahmā.

By reciting giū wang seven times over a dot,
all people shall fail to see you.

Or else, kneeling without moving,
go before a painted image of Mañjuśrī,

and recite this mantra of Mañjuśrī one hundred thousand times.

Offer especially to fish.

From before dawn, reciting through the night,

at the first light the first sign will come: the earth will quake.

The second sign: the sun will reverse its course.

In the four directions a great sound will ring through the sky,

and the roar of thunder, ha ha, will resound.

The third sign: from the sky, vidyādhara

will rain down flowers, garlands hanging, raised aloft.

Thereafter, all the vidyādhara

surrounded by the guardians of the world

will attend, and the Wrathful King himself will come

and speak to you in a pleasing voice:

"Whatever you desire, speak it, my child."

Say whatever you wish — that you may become the King of Vidyādhara,

that you may become invisible, and so on, whatever you desire.

Once the accomplishment is achieved, adorned with the eight-and-two ornaments,

holding a sword in hand,

mounting a divine vehicle,

and traveling together with a vast assembly of vidyādhara

to the many buddha-fields —

when the bodhisattvas (the sons of the Victors) pay homage

and great offerings are received,

you will dwell for life through many eons.

Take a blue utpala lotus petal and a strip of writing material,

place nutmeg (rutra) in a copper vessel with a pill.

Recite while the moon is seized by an eclipse,

then anoint the eyes: the desire realm will become clear to your sight,

and you yourself will be seen by no one.

A meteorite-iron vajra, sixteen finger-widths in length,

with two faces and three prongs in shape —

anoint it with red sandalwood and fine perfume.

From the second day of the miraculous month through the day of the fish,

make offerings and recite. Finally,

make offerings with a hundred butter-lamps and more.

Sitting upon a seat of kuśa grass,
take the vajra in both hands at once.
It blazes with smoke-dispelling light, and thereupon
you will attain the sovereignty of a wheel-turning vidyādhara,
together with all your retinue.

The seven wheels and more, along with weapons,
gold, sandals, divine thread, and all else you require —
accomplish all of this in like manner.

Attainments arise following the methods of old.

On the first day, at midday, strike the thumb of a divine image
with nutmeg while reciting the mantra.

By eight thousand recitations, light rays will shoot forth from the thumb.

Upon contact, the hair of the head will coil into locks,
and together with the retinue you shall attain the rank of King of Vidyādhara.
A body will be accomplished that none can overpower.

The lifespan will endure to the end of an eon.

Draw eight lotus petals on the ground.

Wind a black thread around a vase.

Smear it with sandalwood and fill it with incense. Place it upon the lotus, and
sit upon the lotus seat. By eight thousand recitations the ground will split
open, light will appear at the lotus, and light will appear at the ground. Dig a
cubit-deep pit and pour that water into the ritual cake. Whoever takes it up will
attain a lifespan lasting an eon. On the anthill ground, make a lion figure.
Smear it with civet musk and set down the maṇḍala. Make offerings and recite
until it stirs and moves. Having transformed into a lion, ride upon its back and
travel to all the realms of gods of desire and form. Buddha fields too will come
into view. After the passage of ten thousand years of life, one goes to the
abode of the great Vidyādhara.

Whether taught here or not taught here, all the Vidyādhara renowned as
accomplished, without exception, accomplish everything through the practice
of these mantras and deities.

This is the seventh chapter, on accomplishing the Vidyādhara rank, from the
Condensed Tantra of the Great King of Wrathful Vajras, the noble Vajrakrodha.

Now, what is to be explained next is this: the chief among minor karmic
applications is the rite of the planetary lords. It dispels harm and generates

benefit.

In the center of the maṇḍala smeared with the five kinds of cow-substances, place a lotus of many colors in a double tier. In the center is the buddha; likewise in the south, the Dharma — a white vajra-dharma form; in the east, the Saṅgha — green; in the west, Īśvara (the Lord of the World) — red; in the north, Vajrapāṇi; in the northeast, Mañjuśrī — yellow; in the southeast, the face of Yamāntaka, the destroyer of death, is black. He holds a staff and rides a buffalo. In the direction of the immovable protector stands the direction of the rākṣasas. In the direction of wind stands Hayagrīva. The Three Jewels display the Dharma-teaching gesture; the bodhisattvas and wrathful ones bear their own emblems. All are seated upon precious thrones.

Behind these, the planetary lords: in the east, the Sun, white-yellow, rides a horse and holds a lotus; in the west, the Moon, white, holds a white lotus flower and rides a goose; in the south, Mars of red color with red eyes, sits upon a sphere and holds a torch; his hands are the color of gold and he holds a blue lotus; in the north, Mercury, seated on a lotus, is blue in color and holds a book; in the southeast, he rides a nāga — Rāhu, white, holds a wooden staff; in the southwest, seated on a golden throne; in the northeast, Saturn, dark in color, stands above Brahmā and holds a staff; in the northwest, Ketu — dark and smoky, upon a serpent, holds a wheel and bears a sharp green sword. He is seated on a lotus in the presence of the chief figure.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripārakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
bhaginīṃ svāhā — this is the essence-mantra of the Sun.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
sarva-trayaṃ a svāhā — this is that of the Moon.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
abhīryaya svāhā — this is that of Mars.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
subhīśuddhā svāhā — this is that of the red-eyed one.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
visutra-pakāya svāhā — this is that of Jupiter.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
bhikamyadhāya svāhā — this is that of Kīla.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, oṃ
sudharmārṇa raho svāhā — this is that of the white Rāhu.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, om
kṛṣṇavarṇa-phaka svāhā — this is that of Saturn.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarvā-paripūrakebhyaḥ, sarva-thā, om
vikṛtalakuruci svāhā — this is that of Ketu.

Recite each mantra eight thousand eight hundred times. Make offerings with whatever is available, and supplicate. Wealth will increase, fears will be dispelled, illness will be absent, and all classes of obstructors will be vanquished. Even in cases of epidemic and other such afflictions, and diseases seized by planetary spirits, supplicate in the presence of the image and these will be cleared. Whatever one applies — pacification, increase, empowerment, or fierce activity —

all of these will be accomplished.

Take the bones of a human, a vulture, and a snake, bind them together at the right moment, and conceal them at the enemy's door. The enemy will fall ill, their wealth will be ruined, and conflict will arise for them without end. Tiger hair, skull-bone, and owl feathers — hide these at the enemy's door and they will be driven away. A black mongoose, fox bones, one's own blood, and the head of a dried fish — make these into a ball, inscribe the name, and conceal it at the enemy's door; the enemy and their entire retinue will die. Human fat, cemetery ash, and lac: pour these into a skull with teeth, place it at the doorway of the target, and the house will collapse. Press down a kuśa-grass effigy with the foot.

If one wishes to perform the rite of subjugation and recites the mantra of desire, even a great king will be brought under one's power — what need is there to speak of other spirits? For women, livestock, and the like, fashion an effigy bearing one's own name, press down with the left foot, and recite the name. Whatever one desires will certainly be accomplished.

Draw the image of an obstructor on the ground and strike it with the mantra — it will be destroyed. Fashion an effigy of an obstructor from clay, place it down and strike it — it will certainly be cleared. Drive in a ritual peg and scatter weapons. Make a vajra with eight corners like Mount Meru, and make a threshold on the ground. Place the effigy within and press it down with the foot.

For a maṇḍala ritual on a night when one is under the grip of a malign planet: spread fragrant incense and flowers, place a Perfection of Wisdom volume

there, set butter in a copper vessel, and heat it over an acacia wood fire. The three kinds of accomplishment will be attained, and by this one will also come to behold treasure.

With wrathful mind, perform the mudrā of the eye. Recite the secret mantra with fierce hūṃ syllables at the edges. Whoever receives the ash of a charnel ground will be seized by spirits or will become a servant.

Then, the ritual procedure of the mantra of the Unmoving One (Acala) with a single eye shall be explained. Reciting three hundred thousand times in the presence of the image completes the approach-practice of this deity. In a solitary place, offer a cup of grain-wine. Through this one will be perpetually bound in connection. Inscribing hūṃ on the tip of the finger and reciting will disperse clouds. Press the left foot upon the effigy of the enemy together with their gods, recite, and drive in an iron ritual peg. They will become obedient; if pierced, they will die. Bind with yellow thread and illness is purified. If pressed down with a flat stone, they will be suppressed. If sprinkled with goat-skin, they will become obedient. Recite the mantra over a white mustard-seed thread and wear it — it will protect whatever one wishes.

Namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ, sarva-viśvamukhe-bhyaḥ, sarvathā, oṃ caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa hūṃ traṃ thā mahācaṇḍa, acala-kana hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ, apratihāt, tathāgata-jñānasmarā hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

In the river flowing down to the ocean, a lotus smeared with sandalwood — however many times it is turned while reciting the mantra, that many gold coins will be found. On white cloth of a brahmin, or of the Saṅgha, or of a king, or on rough linen, draw a lotus with two borders. In the center write oṃ hūṃ together with the name; in the petals write caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa with phaṭ. In the first border write the root mantra; in the second write the mantra of Mañjuśrī. Make offerings of incense, flowers, and so forth, then roll it up at the appropriate moment and bind it to the body. It clears spirits, disease, and famine. Going into battle, one will be victorious.

Alternatively, write it on a sword four finger-widths in size; draw rays of light entering the interior. Encircle it with the verse beginning "ye dharmā" and so forth. In the center write the essence mantra neatly, together with the name. This too will produce the former qualities.

Make a scroll with a rolling cylinder that is five hand-spans in circumference, positioned at a height of one hand-span. Inside, write the mantra of Mañjuśrī in vermilion, with the head looking upward. Near the mouth write the

dependent-origination mantra. From monkey-fat make an effigy of the enemy; write it with poison and blood from a blade, together with the name-syllables inscribed in rows. Place this at the heart of a liṅga figure. In a triangular black maṇḍala, in the center make a pit one hand-span deep. Place the liṅga within, invert the scroll-cylinder on top. From the first day of the waning lunar fortnight —

until the moonless night.

By day recite the dependent-origination mantra;
at night, the mantra of the wrathful one with a single eye
is to be recited with force.

At the hours of the quarters, and throughout each interval,
revolving to the left, recite the root mantra
sixty-four times.

Guard the Dharma robe with the mantra of Mañjuśrī.
With the Sugata's hundred-syllable mantra
cool the parasol-finial of the stūpa.

Those who destroy the teaching of the buddhas,
who revile the mantras and harm sentient beings,
who hold wrong views, behave perversely,
and do injury to sentient beings —
may the ten great wrathful kings,
the world-protectors, and the four great kings,
the assembly of the mother-spirits, the planetary lords, and the constellation
hosts,
and those who delight in the Dharma swiftly liberate them.

Proclaim also the power of the truth renowned in other tantras,
invoking it again and again.

In a charnel ground, make a stūpa of earth:
black, triangular, one cubit in size.
Around a black triangular life-stake
bind it with the Sugata's hundred-syllable mantra,
and write upon it with saffron and litharge.
On a triangular piece of aśoka wood
lay out rows of the great syllables of dominion in sequence.
Write the syllables LAṂ and STAMBHAYA eight times
in the eight directions; in the center of the fence

write the name of the intimate enemy.
At the heart of that, write the core:
write the name of the one to be slain.
Offer tormas to the lord of the assembly.
To the mamos and to the noble sons
offer flesh, blood, and black flowers.
If this is performed without laziness
for as long as three times seven days,
whatever monk, novice, or lay follower keeping vows
is engaged in this practice —
the evil one will swiftly die. That is certain.

Now what is to be properly explained further:
the various rites of the fierce Vajradhara (Skt. Vajradhara, the vajra-holder)
are in general common,
but a few special applications are here set out.

Smearing with white mustard drives away elemental spirits.
To ward off hail, write upon a wheel,
or upon a drum or conch.

When entering battle, write upon a sword and the like.
For illness, write a wheel on a water-vessel of white mustard;
trace it around with a skull, then place it in an earthen bowl,
and write it to protect a child's mouth and voice.

A four-finger effigy of monkey-fat,
with charnel-ground ash and the mantra recited over it, placed above the
door,
will certainly protect a sick person from demonic possession.

Place the name and mantra at the heart of the image,
insert thorns in the mouth to cause the voice to be blocked.
If inserted at the heart, anger is pacified;
if done with determined intent, death will certainly follow.
A liṅga image without the proper signs has no power.

Alternatively, into a skull from a lineage-severed person,
write the name and mantra and fill it with human blood;
hide it at a lineage-severed burial site — the family line will be cut off.
Into a black dog's skull, together with name and mantra,

fill with poison and hide at a nāga dwelling — one who holds beauty will be seized.

Hidden at the enemy's door, it causes a split;
hidden in a field, it ruins the harvest for two years;
hidden where livestock dwell, losses will arise within the month;
hidden in a water-channel, the water will dry up;
hidden in a fire-pit, an epidemic will take hold.

Alternatively, write the enemy's name in blood,
and place it at the heart of a monkey-fat effigy.

Place it inside a black stūpa one cubit tall,
set it in a pit, and invert a bowl over it.

Recite the mantra four times, moving in reverse from the dark of the moon,
proclaim the power of the truth, and burn the effigy.

The enemy will die without doubt.

Take blade-blood, crow's blood, and owl's blood,
at the navel of katā, in the time of karo and ka.

Write the name and mantra upon the effigy.

Trampled underfoot, it will be reduced to dust —
just as the Vajra-holder has commanded.

Into the skull of one slain by a weapon,
write the mantra together with the name of the local deity.

Place it in the deity's abode; upon that,
recite the mantra and apply the phurba (Skt. kīla) to the heart.
Kindle a fire offering with thorns of a poisonous plant;
mix the varied blood of humans, horses, oxen, dogs, and goats,
and speak these words:

"O deity, bring down hail and lightning upon this region!

If you do not, you yourself shall burn for an aeon!"

After that, make an offering of white and sweet things.

This is the eighth chapter, on minor ancillary applications, from the Tantra
That Condenses the Ritual Compendium of the Great Noble Wrathful King
Vajra.

Now shall be taught the means by which all fire-offering rites
are swiftly accomplished.

Burning the three sweets together with durgā grass clears away all forms of harm. Burning three fruits from the śami tree pacifies all spirit-afflictions and illnesses. If one burns a hundred offerings on a śami wood of the milky-tree kind, using milk, durgā grass, sesame, and rice, with a mind of compassion, all harm is pacified. Burning camphor, the three sweets, and all grains together with white durgā grass on milky-tree wood pacifies all illness and spirit-afflictions.

One hundred and eight milk fire offerings pacify great cattle plague. Burning durgā grass, the three sweets, and a name-tablet pacifies illness among horses and livestock.

The colors for the east, south, west, and north are, respectively, white, black, red, and yellow. A hearth measuring one cubit or two cubits, with a four-finger-wide opening, and offerings placed in it in order — with this, through the lotus vajra of the heroic one, the four activities of pacification, enrichment, magnetizing, and wrathful action are all accomplished by a single practitioner.

Now shall be taught the enrichment fire offering through which whatever one desires is obtained.

One hundred thousand offerings into lotus water: one attains kingship and ministers. Three hundred thousand offerings of kumuda flowers, together with yogurt and the three sweets, are performed. One hundred thousand offerings of the fruit of apāmārga together with the three sweets: one attains lordship over a region. Seven hundred thousand offerings of fine lineage bring about the attainment of whatever one desires in mind. Burning durgā grass, sesame, rice, and similar substances: one obtains a good wife and fine sons. One who desires wealth places the right hand of a thief in a treasury, makes offerings and supplications, and thereby swiftly obtains wealth. Alternatively, on a piece of frog skin, write a large, proud, yellow rat using saffron and guyuk pigment made with aconite juice; place it facing east, looking toward the treasury's interior; make offerings with food remnants and offer supplications, and wealth will be found.

The pollen of a lotus, kālikā, and priyaṅgu — these bring the finding of wealth. Burning rice also brings great wealth. Burning the fruit of kumuda and similar things brings great prosperity and land. One hundred thousand fire offerings of lotus, yogurt, honey, and butter: the excellent gift of all three higher realms is seen. Burning the fruit of bilva together with the three sweets, three hundred

thousand times: one becomes a great king oneself. Burning butter and white mustard one hundred thousand times on the neem tree causes an old essence to expand greatly. Whatever grain such as barley and similar things one burns with supplication causes that crop to flourish. If one burns flowers of whatever color of cloth one desires, that cloth will be obtained. Burning fragrant wood increases one's retinue and attendants. One thousand offerings of yogurt, butter, and acacia into the fire: wealth is found.

Now shall be explained the method of fire offerings for the wrathful activity of magnetizing.

Burning unthreshed sesame, rice, and similar things in husk: this magnetizes women. Through a fire offering of priyaṅgu, children are brought under one's power. Burning milk, honey, and arura wood magnetizes gods. Burning those three together with guggul magnetizes yakṣas. Using the wood of the grief-free tree magnetizes female yakṣas. Burning a king's mustard together with mustard oil places a king under one's power.

Now shall be clearly explained the fire offerings through which wrathful activities are accomplished.

Burning neem wood with the name-tablet and the proper measure: an enemy who opposes the Dharma quickly dies. Write the enemy's name on a neem leaf with poison, then together with the poison, make five bundles of snakeskin, place them inside five skulls, fill all five with mustard oil, stack three of them on a crossing of two paths, and with one who is in a fury, hair unbound, reciting mantras until the bundles are reduced to ash — if they burn for half a day, the enemy is certain to die. The leaf, root, and bark of the death-omen plant, goat's blood, mustard oil, salt, and long pepper: burn these seven weeks along with the name-tablet on the wood of a hot-natured fire-kindling tree. Two thousand such burnings cause horses and livestock to die.

With four burnings, one's own child and wife die. With six, the family circle and kinship bonds are ruined. With eight, the enemy's very life is cut. If the enemy comes seeking refuge, burn one thousand portions of milk and the antidote restores him to health.

Blood, powdered poison, and the fruit of the neem tree: anoint with mustard oil and burn one hundred and eight times in an intoxicant-fire — the enemy dies. Or alternatively: the five parts of bone powder of neem, anointed with one's own blood or with mustard oil; or else destroy with long-pepper poison together with the fruit of neem. Or burning with sword-blood causes the effigy

to be swiftly destroyed. The five parts of neem, goat's blood, poison, five kinds of foul substances — place the enemy's name-tablet among them and pierce with a phurba: the vidyā-mantra itself turns the evil back upon the sender.

With lac powder and powdered human bone, draw the enemy's likeness on fresh human skin, smear it lightly with poison and long-pepper, and with furious intent warm it over a neem fire — the burning causes death by fever. The antidote: the afflicted person is cured with milk-soaked dūrvā grass.

Burn poison, neem, white garlic, and powdered human bone, and livestock are destroyed. The three hot spices together with salt, dūrvā, and natural sour substance; mustard oil, corpse-hair, snakeskin, the five parts of neem, powdered human bone, long-pepper powder, and sliced garlic — burn these over a thorn-fire and the enemy vomits blood and dies. Burn lac together with salt and ox bile — the enemy dies of liver-splitting disease. Burn moist earth-marrow, salt, and the three hot spices, and draw the likeness on a charnel-ground sickle-piece, burning from the head down to the feet with black ink — it kills. The antidote: burn the three white substances on a milk-bearing yam-wood and the afflicted one is cured.

Take earth cleared of fragrant water, make a hearth, smear it with poison, write the enemy's name on a neem leaf in goat's blood, roll it up, and burn it on a wood-fire of the three hot spices — a king will certainly die swiftly. Poison, blood, salt, and the three hot spices: burn the name-inscribed effigy on a nimi-fire and the enemy will be killed by dropsy or leprosy. The three hot spices, nimi-wood, poison, dūrvā, blood, and salt — make an effigy, coat it with salt, nimi-wood, and hot butter, and burn it on a marking-nut tree fire: the enemy is seized by great leprosy and dies. Goat's blood, the three hot spices, mustard oil, incense, neem leaves, and garden cress: burn with mustard oil and poison — death by fever. Or garden cress, poison, and salt; the five parts of datura; and the three hot spices: make the enemy's effigy from charcoal, smear with mustard oil and burn — he dies.

With the fruit of the three hot spices, write the enemy's name on a neem leaf, place it together with poison and mustard seed inside a skull, boil the five parts of datura, and bind the enemy. The vidyā-goddess should face north while the practitioner himself faces south.

Brahmā and the assembled hosts of gods, the miracle-endowed world-guardians, the Māmō goddesses, ḍākinīs, flesh-eaters and their like, the lords of the ten grounds endowed with bodhicitta, the vidyādhara kings who

are the wrathful kings, and the deities of the buddha-maṇḍalas — I summon you all. This sinful one, filled with pride, malice, and anger — a nihilist who reviles mantras, who has despoiled the Three Jewels, who hates the Dharma and harms sentient beings, who commits the five acts of immediate consequence — I beseech you to liberate him. May he be shaken by wind and drenched by rain, scorched by fire, afflicted by dust-storms and drought arising here. May lions, garuḍas, tigers, and wrathful ones crush him; may insects, bees, and wild hornets draw his blood; may flocks of birds carry him off into the sky. This is the meditative absorption of the karma of fierce activity.

Now follow the miscellaneous rites:

Powdered human bone, long-pepper, and life-seed; a yakṣa-coupling poison-wood — burn these together with the distinct name-tablet and it causes expulsion, separation, and madness. The antidote: cure with dūrvā grass taken with milk. The five limbs and fruit of datura burned on a thorn-fire causes madness. The three hot spices with salt produces a fever illness, or causes the victim to dry up like dry wood. Jamba-goat with natural sour substance afflicts the enemy with a cold illness. Apply crow's feathers smeared with eranda butter to datura and burn it — and the enemy wanders in all directions like a khaṭvāṅga-wielder, powerless. Long-pepper, human bone, salt, poison —

mustard oil burned on a nīm-wood fire causes the enemy to quarrel constantly and to be struck by all manner of illnesses. Cemetery ash with charcoal — press these into an effigy of the enemy and pierce it through with a stake or peg: this produces the eye-disease known as pholmik and grave illness. The flesh of a vulture, an owl, and a cat, and the fur of a mongoose — burn these sixty-eight together on a fire, and it is certain to quickly sever two allied parties. If one draws an image on a blood-soaked cloth, presses it down with the left foot together with a stake, and employs fierce desire-mantras, it produces fainting, fever-illness, and spleen-disease. Take the enemy's hair and soil from his footprint, smear an effigy of the enemy with poison and the flesh of a skunk, and burn it on a thorn-fire: the enemy becomes bewitched. The enemy's white bones, poison, and natural sour substance — if one makes an effigy and burns it on a nīm-wood fire, the enemy is struck by a great spirit-illness. Pig-fat, snuha-plant, and arga-wood burned on a thorn-fire causes dizziness. Mongoose, cat, and rat fur — if burned, it causes a woman to lose her children. The bones of a human, a mongoose, and a crow, burned with mustard oil on a nīm-wood fire, drives people from their village or town. Tiger

fur, skull-bone, and owl feathers, the flower of the sahā plant, the naleshama herb, and nīm leaves — burn these with poison. The fruit of the nīm tree, poison, salt, and datura seeds burned together produces illness. With poisoned blood and datura fruit, write the enemy's name on a nīm-wood stick, smear it with the three hot spices, salt, and blood, place mustard oil inside an iron vessel, and cook it over a nīm-wood fire: this separates the enemy from his gods. The powdered bones of a human, a dog, and a vulture, mixed with poison, the flesh of a skunk, mustard oil, and snakeskin, together with the five parts of the nīm tree, white knotgrass, and salt — if burned on a thorn-fire, it strikes with illness. The flesh of a skunk, poison, white knotgrass, snakeskin, and hot butter — make an effigy and torment it over a hot fire: this causes excessive rain and brings down lightning.

This concludes the ninth chapter, on fire-offerings, from the Tantra Called the Condensed Procedures of the Noble Vajra, King of Fierce Ones.

Then Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and all the others throughout the assembled maṇḍala of the retinue rose, joined their palms, and with melodious voice deliberately spoke these words:

How wonderful! To all the buddhas, skillful means and wisdom are inconceivable. With a mind moved by compassion, you have proclaimed this incomparable, vast, and sacred Dharma. The earth is filled with the terror of poison; yet here, in this nectar of fine light that knows no fear of the darkness of affliction, whoever takes refuge — the terror of the lower realms will be emptied.

Then Brahmā and the other world-protectors, all those endowed with miraculous powers, gathering together and filled with joy, offered these words of praise in beautiful speech:

How wonderful! O great lord of buddhas, delighting to be a healer for all sentient beings — the incomparable, inconceivable skillful means of the great protector, the guardian of the world: whoever abides in what has been proclaimed here purifies the ocean of saṃsāric suffering. By accomplishing the vision of the medicine for beings, supreme happiness will arise.

Then Vajrapāṇi and the assembly of bodhisattvas, gazing with eyes of wonder, spoke these words of deliberate praise:

How wonderful! O inconceivable buddha — from the very beginning you have taken into your heart the welfare of beings. Freed from the intrinsic nature of

non-conceptuality, you have proclaimed an inconceivable attainment. The first who holds this severs the lower realms; the second achieves visible, this-life siddhis; after that, fearlessness and the absence of self arise; and when doubt is abandoned, exhaustion is overcome. Abiding on the grounds, you work for the benefit of sentient beings spontaneously and without obstruction. Having trained in this king of secret mantras, the protector of all, every desired aim is accomplished — and just as space, water, and gold are pure, the supreme meditation causes the mind to expand. Then the assembly of vidyādhara masters, without exception, gathered together, scattered flowers upon the chief,

and then spoke aloud this solemn declaration:

"How wondrous — the buddhas are inconceivable!
The sublime Dharma is also inconceivable!
Working for the welfare and benefit of beings,
through the names of the rites, through wisdom,
and through the distinctions of compassion fully expanded,
he moves beautifully, that yogin,
like a lotus risen free from the terrors
of the lower realms — the Avīci hells and the rest.

Then all the wrathful ones of the ten directions,
possessed of great power and might,
gathered together, and with great exuberance
spoke in verse this solemn declaration:

"How wondrous — the buddhas, the great Dharma,
and the Saṅgha, the Jewel, are inconceivable!
In the vast darkness of saṃsāra,
sunk in torpor, hard to behold, and hard to understand —
the mantra and the mudrā are inconceivable.
Even by the mere sight or mere hearing of them,
even the fierce and terrible spirits (bhūtas), hard to behold,
will have an elevated mind arise within them.

Then the great goddesses of vidyā (vidyādevīs),
the vast and noble ones headed by Locana,
filled with wonder, cast their gaze forth,
and sweetly spoke this solemn declaration:

"How wondrous — the buddhas are marvellous!
How wondrous — the buddhas are great heroes!
How wondrous — the buddhas are supremely profound!
Phenomena neither arise nor cease —
yet like the play of manifold magical illusions,
he satisfies those to be tamed through illusion-like appearances,
free from conceptual elaboration, beyond elaboration,
while causing illusions to proliferate abundantly."

Then the buddhas of the ten directions,
beholding those to be tamed throughout the billion-world realm,
gazed upon them fully,
and with words of wonder and marvel
praised the Vajra-holder (Vajradhāra), the tamer of beings,
with this solemn declaration:

OM — First, homage: bestower of auspiciousness!
Purified of miserliness, with mastery over requisites —
with the power that knows what is possible and what is not —
with Supernal Joy and wrathful gnosis, I bow to the Victor over the three
realms.

The syllable TṢA — fragrant as sandalwood, matching in character the scent of
good incense applied:
pure in ethical discipline, with mastery over life —
with the power that knows karma and karmic maturation —
I bow to the immovable Wrathful King of stainless gnosis.

The syllable Ḍa — calm abiding that scatters the obscurations of affliction,
pure patience, with mastery over birth —
with the power called knowing the diverse inclinations —
I bow to the wrathful one of radiant gnosis, blue-club in hand.

The syllable MA — lord of the great magical display and vast insight
(vipaśyanā),
through pure diligence, with mastery of the mind in proper order —
with the power that knows the many kinds of elements —
I bow to the light-making gnosis, to the fierce Yamāntaka.

The syllable HĀ — greatly purified through training, the plunderer of the
cognitive obscurations, unstained,
through pure meditative concentration, with mastery over miraculous powers

—

with the power of the path that leads all to purification —

I bow to the wrathful one, the gnosis hard to purify, Hayagrīva.

The syllable RO — mastery over actions, arising from knowing sickness-free,
pure, saṃsāra and nirvāṇa:

through meditative concentration, liberation, meditative absorption, and
entrance into equanimity —

with the power of the all-knowing view, thoroughly purified of all afflictions —

I bow to the manifest gnosis, the King of Desire.

The syllable ŚA — the great vow of equality, the great sovereign king:

from great power, mastery over aspiration —

with the power of recollecting previous states of existence —

I bow to the far-ranging gnosis, swirling with ambrosia.

The syllable Ṇa — the great person, of great sound, supreme nāga and chief:

through pure aspiration, mastery over great aspiration —

with the power that knows the supreme and the non-supreme faculties —

I bow to the wrathful one of immovable gnosis, of great power.

The syllable HŪṂ — Hulu, cloud-veiled, voiced with the resounding thunder of
a dragon:

through pure skillful means, mastery over great gnosis —

with the power that knows death and transmigration and whoever is born —

I bow to the wrathful one of excellent wisdom-gnosis, the Maker of HŪṂ.

The syllable PHAṬ — scattering all habitual tendencies by its sound, purified
like crystal:

through pure gnosis, mastery over Dharma —

with the power that knows through the complete exhaustion of all defilements

—

I bow to the wrathful gnosis of the Dharma-cloud, beautiful and glorious.

Then the Dharma Lord, the Sage —

Extending the sovereign organ of his tongue and gazing out with a smile, the
Dharma Lord spoke, in the midst of the great maṇḍala of the assembly, to the
mighty Vajrapāṇi with words of sweet and pleasing speech — praise supremely
firm:

The Vajra Vehicle (Skt. vajrayāna), unsurpassed and supreme —

the very moment any person, even one of little merit,

or even one who has committed the acts of immediate retribution,
enters into this tantra,
just as the alchemical elixir that transmutes base metal into gold,
all mistaken conceptual thoughts are entirely purified
and one arrives in the body of non-conceptual bliss.
Like a mind held in a beautiful dream,
one appears in whatever variety of emanations arise.

This supreme great vessel that crosses
the boundless and shoreless ocean of saṃsāra —
hold it always, without concealment or secrecy,
in the manner of one who holds it purely.

Vajrapāṇi, the greatly powerful one,
then made this request to the Teacher:
The very moment this tantra is drawn forth,
those difficult to tame are utterly pacified.
From the earth, disease, malevolent spirits, famine,
and all obstacles and harms are dispelled.
Again, for the flourishing of the teaching,
I shall hold it firmly.

The heroes and ḍākinīs, the wrathful ones,
even those who have made the offering-vow of mind,
shall follow in the wake of whoever holds this tantra.
Gods and worldly beings,
māmo spirits, rākṣasīs, ḍākinīs,
flesh-eaters, yakṣas, and demonesses —
all these shall protect the holder of this tantra
and cause the wealth of the tantra-holder to increase.

The Teacher spoke and Vajrapāṇi replied:
Excellent! Most excellent indeed!
May that great yogin who holds this tantra
be protected continuously and may wisdom increase!

Upon hearing these words,
the bodhisattvas, the śrāvakas,
the ḍākinīs, the māmo spirits, the world-guardians,
gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, and all the rest —

the entire assembly gathered there

rejoiced, pressed their palms together, and were filled with delight.

With the unmoving iron hook of compassion, drawing beings from the prison of saṃsāra,

hundreds of thousands of gods and nāgas, unstained and white, with minds of virtuous intention —

obtaining birth, awakening, and the precious jewel: marvelous and wondrous!

This Dharma of the Victors, summarized in its essence, is exceedingly secret for the lowly.

This is the tenth chapter, the chapter of rejoicing, from the Condensed Tantra of the Noble King of the Vajra Wrathful Ones.

The Condensed Tantra of the Noble King of the Vajra Wrathful Ones is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The list of bodhisattvas includes several whose Tibetan epithets are rendered by meaning rather than attested Sanskrit equivalents. "Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin" (ཀུན་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་སྒྲུབ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་) is the standard identification. "Śāntamati" (ཤར་བཤིག་པའི་མཆོག་ལྷ་མོ་), "Vicitravikīrṇa" (འཇིག་རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་), "Gaganalocanadhara" (གཤམ་གྱི་ལྷ་མོ་), "Ākāśagarbha" (འཁོར་ལྷ་མོ་), and "Rūpaśuddha" (རྒྱུ་ཤུག་ལྷ་མོ་) are reconstructed Sanskrit equivalents; the last three are well attested; the middle two are less commonly documented by name and the Sanskrit is reconstructed here.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, listing beings before the verse is complete; the translation follows the Tibetan precisely and does not supply the missing conclusion.

The term "ཀྱིམ་ན་ལྷ་མོ་" (kiṃnara) is rendered as "kiṃnaras," the mythological half-human beings, which is standard.

• The phrase rendered "hair pore-reliquaries of all the buddhas" translates a compound that literally means "reliquary" or "treasury" at the hair-pore (ūrṇā or more generally from the body-pores). In tantric iconographic context this refers to light-rays and hosts of deities emanating from the pores or hair-follicles of buddha-bodies; the rendering preserves this technical sense while remaining accessible.

The line "does not abide at any extreme" renders "mi gnas ye shes," the gnosis of non-abiding, a reference to non-abiding nirvāṇa (apratīṣṭhitanirvāṇa), the awakening state that abides neither in saṃsāra nor in a one-sided nirvāṇa. This is a key Mahāyāna doctrinal term.

The final list of ten virtuous practices (writing, offering, giving, listening, retaining, reading, making offerings, reciting, reflecting, meditating) corresponds to a standard tenfold enumeration of Dharma practice found across Mahāyāna sūtras and here adapted to the tantric context.

• The phrase rendered "the form of a great ascetic" translates dge sbyong chen po, literally "great śramaṇa," referring to a great renunciant; in context this likely alludes to the Buddha's

own appearance as a wandering ascetic, or to a monastic form.

The verse "for some as the form of a rākṣasa or rākṣasī" renders *srin po srin mo*, the male and female flesh-eating demons of Indian mythology, here listed among the wrathful emanation forms of the bodhisattva-protector.

The final two lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete in the source — the text breaks off mid-sentence at the colophon transition into the next chapter, hence the translation ends at the last grammatically complete unit.

- The phrase rendered "the Victor arisen as a self-cause without any cause" translates "rgyal ba rgyu med bdag nyid 'khrungs," which is a paradoxical doctrinal claim: the awakened one is beyond both cause and the causal process of conditioned existence, yet arises as his own ground. This reflects the tathāgatagarbha-inflected tantric view of the text, not a theistic creator-god claim.

The verse on "single syllable of great splendor" likely refers to a root or seed-syllable of the deity being praised, consistent with tantric dhāraṇī literature; the specific syllable is not named in this passage.

- The mantra syllables throughout this passage are reproduced in transliteration as faithfully as possible from the Tibetan phonetic rendering. Many syllables are corrupt or variant forms typical of tantric transmission; no attempt has been made to normalize or correct them, as their liturgical form is intentional.

The phrase rendered "interrupts offerings" and "interrupts hearing, reflection, and practice" translates *bar du gcod pa*, literally "to cut in between," a standard idiom for obstacle-spirits interfering with spiritual activity.

The colophon verse ending "like the blade of a sharp sword" closes the second chapter and functions as a summary verse contrasting the ultimate remedy (bodhicitta) with the gross interference of spirit obstacles — a doctrinal juxtaposition typical of this genre of *kriyā-tantra* and *mahāyoga* ritual literature.

- The Tibetan term མཐོག་མཆོག་ (mamo) denotes a class of fierce feminine spirits in the Indo-Tibetan tantric tradition; "offering spirits" is used here for the sake of intelligibility, though "mamos" would be the more precise designation. Similarly, མཐོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་ ("sisters") in this ritual context refers to a class of female attendant or guardian figures associated with the maṇḍala assembly.

The term མཐོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་ (literally "the offering fitting as a footstool" or "footrest-level offering") is a technical ritual term for an offering placed at the lowest level, typically at the feet of the invited guests; "footstool offering" renders this functionally.

The phrase མཐོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་མཆོག་ refers to the invitation of "heroes" (vīras), the male tantric practitioners or deity-figures of that class; "heroes" is retained as the most transparent rendering.

- The passage lists the twenty-seven classical Sanskrit lunar mansions plus Abhijit, together with the nine grahas (planets in Indian astronomy), naming them in their Sanskrit forms transliterated into Tibetan. These have been restored to standard Sanskrit here. "Abhijit" appears between Uttarāṣāḍhā and Śravaṇā, its traditional position as the intercalary nakṣatra.

The mudrā descriptions are highly technical and prescribe precise finger configurations for ritual use. The terminology follows standard Tibetan tantric mudrā instruction texts. Several compound gesture terms are translated according to the named mudrā conventions of such ritual manuals rather than purely by their literal meaning, which would be opaque or misleading in isolation.

- The term rendered "sisters of accomplishment" for རྒྱལ་ལོ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ is a somewhat unusual compound; it likely refers to a class of dākinī or female attendant spirits associated with siddhi, and the rendering preserves both elements of the compound. The precise ritual choreography described throughout is highly technical and some ambiguity in the sequence of limb movements is unavoidable given the compressed verse form; the translation follows the most grammatically natural reading in each case.
- The passage contains extensive lists of pigment names and materials in Tibetan, many of which are technical color-preparation terms drawn from Indo-Tibetan painting traditions. Several terms are rendered by best available identification: "bronze-flower" for sponge, "malachite" for mu zi kan, "orpiment" for ba bla kra, "lapis-red" for li khri, "vermilion shell" for sgo nga, "red ochre" for mtshal spags, "indigo" for rams, "blue-bark" for mthing shun, and "gypsum blue" for bru nir. The term she twa rendered as śvetā chalk follows Sanskrit identification of the white pigment. Some of these identifications carry moderate uncertainty, though the overall sequence follows standard thangka preparation instruction and the doctrinal content is unaffected.

The phrase rendered "a day on the divine boundary" translates lha mtshams, an auspicious calendrical designation; its precise technical meaning varies by tradition.

The architectural structure of the maṇḍala image description is dense and some pronoun referents are ambiguous in the original; the translation follows the most grammatically and iconographically coherent reading.

- The zarma flower referenced as the color of the Immovable One's complexion is likely the shirisha or a yellow-complexioned flower in the Indic botanical tradition; the term specifies a particular warm golden-yellow hue and is left transliterated in sense rather than botanically identified, as the precise species is uncertain in context.

The phrase rendered "two divine sons fan him with relief" describes attendant figures who relieve the deity's exertion; the Tibetan "dbugs 'byin" literally means "to cause to breathe" or "to give relief," often depicted as attendants fanning the central figure.

- The passage contains a mantra sequence in Sanskrit that is transliterated from Tibetan; the Sanskrit has been rendered in normalized transliteration following standard restoration conventions. The Sanskrit reads as an abbreviated variant of a known purification formula associated with the tathāgata family and dharmadhātu; the transliteration from the Tibetan source contains some orthographic irregularities that have been silently normalized.

The section giving numerical sequences ("the third of the fifth, the fifth of the fourth," and so on) describes a finger-position or syllable-placement code within the mantra body visualization. This is a deliberate esoteric encoding whose precise referent is intentionally concealed from uninitiated readers; it is not a textual corruption. A full technical explication would require commentary literature.

The term rendered "Garuḍa" appears as "sky-soarer" in the Tibetan, which is a standard kenning for garuḍa in this context.

- The phrase rendered "the motionless one bearing the crown ornament" refers to Akṣobhya, the Tathāgata of the east, whose name means "the Unshakeable" or "the Immovable." The context is the empowerment sequence in which Akṣobhya presides at the crown.

The line "making oneself into a syllable" describes a visualization practice in which the practitioner dissolves into or identifies with a seed syllable, then practices with a subtle fire-like form by night — a standard tantric yogic instruction.

The colophon formula identifies this as chapter five of the root tantra; the text then transitions to a new chapter on the ritual procedure of mantra practice, with the empowerment liturgy that follows.

- The passage is a ritual-technical prescription for maṇḍala construction, listing deity placements, architectural measurements, and site requirements. Several deity epithets are rendered by function or meaning where a Sanskrit or standard Tibetan proper name is not entirely transparent from the text alone — for example, "Space-Heart," "Earth-Heart," and "Blazing-Fire one" are approximations of epithets that correspond to Ākāśagarbha and Kṣitigarbha and a form of Vajrapāṇi respectively. "Daring Ascetic" renders the wrathful deity name brtul phod, a colloquial wrathful epithet without a widely fixed Sanskrit equivalent. The directional assignment of "Vajra" to both south and west in the gate section reflects ambiguity in the source text; the reading preserved here follows the likely liturgical scheme. "Ūṛṇā Woman" renders mdzod spu ma, literally the female deity associated with the ūṛṇā, the curl of hair between a buddha's brows, here functioning as a deity name.
- The mantra syllables are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration, preserving the Sanskrit phonology. Minor orthographic variation from standard Sanskrit is inherent to the Tibetan transcription tradition and is not a translation error.

The phrase "Obstacle-Holder Woman" renders bgegs-'dzin-ma, a wrathful female deity whose name means one who holds or captures obstacles and obstructing forces.

The identity of the deity called "World-Magnetizer" in the center of the Vajra Dharma maṇḍala corresponds to a form of Avalokiteśvara or a related magnetizing figure; the text does not specify further.

The closing lines of the passage are syntactically incomplete, ending mid-list. This is because the source passage itself breaks off mid-sentence; the translation faithfully reflects the incomplete enumeration.

- The udumbara flower is a traditional Buddhist image for extreme rarity, said to bloom only once in an immense span of time, sometimes glossed as appearing only when a buddha arises in the world. The text uses it here to underscore the rarity of both encountering a buddha and finding a teacher who embodies secret mantra practice.

The phrase rendered "throughout the open sky of empty moments" for "gnam stong la" is an idiomatic expression; it likely means "in the open expanse" or refers to specific auspicious lunar days, extending the list of days on which the precepts should be especially observed. The preceding days — eighth, eleventh, and fifteenth — are standard Vinaya and lay observance days.

The closing line naming the "Noble King of Wrathful Vajra" refers to Vajrakrodharāja, a wrathful tantric deity. The tantra cited is a known category of Vajrayāna canonical literature.

- The term "giū wang" appears to be a horn or animal-derived pendant or amulet substance held in high regard in Tibetan ritual — possibly referring to a talisman made from a particular horn. It is left in transliteration as it appears in the preceding passage and its precise identification is uncertain.

The phrase rendered "from the second day of the miraculous month through the day of the fish" refers to a specific ritual calendar period; "the miraculous month" is likely the month of miracles, the first Tibetan month, and "the day of the fish" is the last day of the relevant festival period, though the exact calendrical reckoning here may vary by tradition.

The passage ends mid-sentence with the winding of black thread around a vase, as the source text concludes here.

- The identification of individual planets with their mantras rests on the Tibetan labels following each mantra. The matching of "ཀླུ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་" (red-eyed one) with Mars and "ཀླུ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་" with Jupiter follows the standard Tibetan nine-planet system where these are conventional identifications; the sequence here is somewhat irregular and the planet assigned to each mantra has been rendered according to its label in the text rather than strict positional inference.

The mantras are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan; the Sanskrit underlying them is partially recoverable but in several cases the syllables are garbled or corrupted in transmission, so the transliteration is diplomatic rather than emended.

"ཀླུ་མེད་ཀྱི་ལྷ་" rendered as "Rāhu, white" follows the context of the directional placement and the subsequent mantra label; the Tibetan compound is unusual and this reading is tentative.

- The passage is a ritual manual listing a sequence of wrathful and subjugating rites. The term rendered "scroll with a rolling cylinder" is "par bu" (a cylindrical or tubular object used as a ritual roll or scroll-cylinder); the exact form is somewhat uncertain but the sense of a cylindrical object containing inscribed text and inverted over a pit is consistent with the context.

The mantra "namaḥ sarva-tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva-viśvamukhe-bhyaḥ" represents a slightly variant recension of a dhāraṇī associated with Acala-nātha (the Unmoving One); the Tibetan syllables have been rendered in reconstructed Sanskrit as standard for mantra passages.

- The phrase rendered "the wrathful one with a single eye" refers to the single-eyed wrathful deity central to this ritual system; the identity is left implicit in the Tibetan.

The syllables LAM and STAMBHAYA are retained untranslated as they are seed-syllables and mantra elements rather than ordinary words; STAMBHAYA means "paralyze" or "immobilize" in the ritual context.

The section containing "katā," "karo," and "ka" presents genuine obscurity: these appear to be technical ritual time-designations or corrupted proper names, possibly Sanskrit, whose precise referents are unclear in the received text. They are transliterated rather than guessed at.

The phrase rendered "noble sons" in the offering to the mamos refers to a class of associated spirits or protector beings, here contrasted with the mamos themselves.

- The term rendered "three sweets" refers to the standard ritual triad of sugar, honey, and molasses or similar sweet substances, conventional in fire-offering contexts.

The phrase "lotus vajra of the heroic one" is a technical tantric epithet whose precise referent is not fully transparent from context alone; it likely refers to a specific deity or the practitioner's ritual identity.

"Kumuda" is a white water-lily; "priyaṅgu" is a flowering vine used in Āyurvedic and ritual contexts; "apāmārga" is *Achyranthes aspera*, a plant used in fire-ritual traditions; "bilva" is the bael tree; "guggul" is *Commiphora mukul* resin.

The phrase rendered "the excellent gift of all three" for the three recipients — or possibly "those of the three higher realms will be seen" — is syntactically ambiguous in the original; this translation follows the more common ritual reading.

- The term rendered "five acts of immediate consequence" translates ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་ལྷན་པ་, literally "one who has the limitless," referring to the five heinous acts (ānantarya) that bring immediate karmic retribution: killing a parent, killing an arhat, wounding a buddha, causing a schism in the Saṅgha, and killing a monk. This is a standard doctrinal term used in the context of the curse-invocation liturgy.

The phrase translated "liberate him" (འགྲོ་བུ་ལྷོ་བྱ་བ་) is the standard tantric euphemism for ritual killing of a demonized enemy: to "liberate" the hostile being's consciousness by force. This double meaning of liberation as both spiritual deliverance and ritual destruction is characteristic of fierce-rite (abhicāra) literature.

The final line is incomplete in the source text and breaks off mid-verse; the translation reflects this by ending without a full sentence.

- The term rendered "pholmik" is a Tibetan medical term for a specific eye pathology; it is left as a descriptive label since no standard Sanskrit equivalent is established and the source gives no gloss.

The phrase "sixty-eight" in the mongoose-owl-cat formula is a literal rendering of "drug cu rtsa brgyad" and likely refers to a specific ritual enumeration in the tradition, though the referent is not further specified in the text.

"Sahā plant" and "naleshama" are left in transliterated form as the botanical identifications are uncertain and the Tibetan does not gloss them.

The line rendered "fearlessness and the absence of self arise" translates "'jigs med nga yi med," which is grammatically compressed; it may mean "the fearlessness of no-self" or "fearlessness, and there is no ego." The rendering reflects the most doctrinally natural reading.

- The passage is a structured liturgical hymn of praise with syllable-by-syllable homages, each seed syllable (OM, TṢA, Ḍa, MA, HĀ, RO, ṢA, Ṇa, HŪM, PHAṬ) linked to a specific wrathful deity, a "power" (one of the ten powers of a buddha, daśabala), a perfection or quality, and a gnosis. The ten powers referenced are the standard set from Mahāyāna doctrine. "Locana" heading the vidyā goddesses is Buddhalocanā, one of the principal goddesses of the Vajrayāna maṇḍala.

"Yamāntaka," "Hayagrīva," and "Vajradhāra" are kept as standard Sanskrit equivalents of the Tibetan epithets rendered. The "King of Desire" for the RO syllable (རྩ་ལྷོ་བྱ་བ་) likely refers to Mahādeva/Kāmadeva in a wrathful tantric context, but within the hymn's schema it denotes a specific wrathful deity; no emendation was made. "Beautiful and glorious" for རྩ་ལྷོ་བྱ་བ་ renders the compound name Yamaṭa-beautiful (ཡ་མ་ཏ་རྩ་ལྷོ་བྱ་བ་), which may be a name of a wrathful deity not otherwise attested clearly.

- The four-line verse near the end shifts into a denser, more compressed register. The third line's phrase translated as "obtaining birth, awakening, and the precious jewel" (skye gnas byang chub rin chen nor thob) could also be read as "obtaining the precious wealth of birthplace and awakening," but the reading adopted here follows the most natural syntactic parsing and fits the doctrinal context of beings being liberated through the tantra's power.

The term māmo (ma mo) denotes a class of fierce female spirits in the Tibetan cosmological scheme; it is left untranslated as an established term in tantric literature. Rākṣasī (srin mo) is rendered as "demonesses" for TTS clarity.

The colophon phrase rendered "acts of immediate retribution" (mtshams med) refers to the five heinous acts that normally lead to immediate rebirth in the lowest hell — a standard doctrinal category (Skt. ānantarya).

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those

texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.